

Quine and Strawson — MCQ Solutions

Proposition-specific explanations and repairs

These are independent learner-practice explanations, not official UPSC answer keys.

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MCQ 1

In the syllabus item "Quine and Strawson", which pairing correctly matches each philosopher to his project?

A. Quine - critique of empiricism, and Strawson - theory of basic particulars and persons. B. Quine - theory of basic particulars and persons, and Strawson - critique of empiricism. C. Both jointly propose a single naturalized theory of persons. D. Quine develops descriptive metaphysics, and Strawson replaces epistemology with naturalized psychology.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Quine - critique of empiricism, and Strawson - theory of basic particulars and persons." Rationale: Quine attacks empiricism from within ("Two Dogmas"); Strawson develops a descriptive metaphysics of basic particulars and persons. The two projects are kept distinct.
- **B:** False proposition: "Quine - theory of basic particulars and persons, and Strawson - critique of empiricism." Correct replacement: "Quine - critique of empiricism, and Strawson - theory of basic particulars and persons." Rationale: This reverses the philosophers' projects: basic particulars and persons belong to Strawson's descriptive metaphysics, while the critique of empiricism is Quine's project.
- **C:** False proposition: "Both jointly propose a single naturalized theory of persons." Correct replacement: "Quine - critique of empiricism, and Strawson - theory of basic particulars and persons." Rationale: This conflates two distinct programmes. Quine naturalizes inquiry and criticizes empiricism, whereas Strawson develops the primitive concept of a person within descriptive metaphysics; they offer no joint theory of persons.
- **D:** False proposition: "Quine develops descriptive metaphysics, and Strawson replaces epistemology with naturalized psychology." Correct replacement: "Quine - critique of empiricism, and Strawson - theory of basic particulars and persons." Rationale: The attribution is reversed. Descriptive metaphysics is Strawson's method, while replacing first philosophy with empirical psychology belongs to Quine's naturalized epistemology and wider critique of empiricism.

Examiner trap: Printed ownership, two-project map and anti-conflation boundary must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C01 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All owned questions; use the ownership table before comparison.

MCQ 2

What single target do Quine and Strawson share, despite their different methods?

A. Classical and logical empiricism, especially atomistic verification. B. Kantian transcendental idealism and its defence of synthetic a priori cognition. C. Hegelian absolute idealism and its dialectical account of conceptual development. D. Aristotelian substance metaphysics and its doctrine of primary substances.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Classical and logical empiricism, especially atomistic verification." Rationale: Both are critics of empiricism - Quine reforms it from within (holism), Strawson challenges its private-given starting point.
- **B:** False proposition: "Kantian transcendental idealism and its defence of synthetic a priori cognition." Correct replacement: "Classical and logical empiricism, especially atomistic verification." Rationale: This misidentifies their shared opponent. Neither project is principally an attack on Kant's defence of the synthetic a priori; both target empiricism, especially atomistic verification and the private-given model.
- **C:** False proposition: "Hegelian absolute idealism and its dialectical account of conceptual development." Correct replacement: "Classical and logical empiricism, especially atomistic verification." Rationale: Hegelian absolute idealism and its dialectic are not the common target at issue. Quine challenges logical empiricism's dogmas, while Strawson rejects the private-given starting point of empiricist accounts.
- **D:** False proposition: "Aristotelian substance metaphysics and its doctrine of primary substances." Correct replacement: "Classical and logical empiricism, especially atomistic verification." Rationale: This misidentifies Aristotelian substance metaphysics and primary substances as the shared target. Their convergence instead concerns empiricism: atomistic confirmation and the priority of private sense-data.

Examiner trap: Printed ownership, two-project map and anti-conflation boundary must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C01 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All owned questions; use the ownership table before comparison.

MCQ 3

Which statement best captures the methodological contrast between the two thinkers?

- A. Both primarily use transcendental arguments to establish necessary conditions of objective experience. B. Quine makes philosophy continuous with science, and Strawson practises descriptive metaphysics. C. Both treat philosophy as continuous with empirical science and reject autonomous conceptual analysis. D. Quine is a descriptive metaphysician, and Strawson is a naturalist.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Both primarily use transcendental arguments to establish necessary conditions of objective experience." Correct replacement: "Quine makes philosophy continuous with science, and Strawson practises descriptive metaphysics." Rationale: The claim wrongly assigns one method to both thinkers. Quine treats philosophy as continuous with science, whereas Strawson's characteristic method is descriptive metaphysics, even when some arguments have a transcendental form.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Quine makes philosophy continuous with science, and Strawson practises descriptive metaphysics." Rationale: Quine's method is naturalism; Strawson's is descriptive (as opposed to revisionary) metaphysics.
- **C:** False proposition: "Both treat philosophy as continuous with empirical science and reject autonomous conceptual analysis." Correct replacement: "Quine makes philosophy continuous with science, and Strawson practises descriptive metaphysics." Rationale: This projects Quine's naturalism onto Strawson. Strawson preserves autonomous conceptual analysis by describing the structure of ordinary thought rather than reducing philosophy to empirical science.
- **D:** False proposition: "Quine is a descriptive metaphysician, and Strawson is a naturalist." Correct replacement: "Quine makes philosophy continuous with science, and Strawson practises descriptive metaphysics." Rationale: This reverses the methodological labels. Quine is the naturalist who makes philosophy continuous with science; Strawson is the descriptive metaphysician who contrasts description with revisionary reconstruction.

Examiner trap: Printed ownership, two-project map and anti-conflation boundary must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C01 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All owned questions; use the ownership table before comparison.

MCQ 4

The claim "Quine reforms empiricism from within while Strawson rejects its starting point" means that:

A. Quine retains empirical constraint, unlike Strawson's rejection of the private given. B. Both abandon empiricism as irredeemable and ground knowledge in rationalist first principles. C. Both take private sense-data as the basic given. D. Quine denies that experience is any check on belief.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Quine retains empirical constraint, unlike Strawson's rejection of the private given." Rationale: Quine's residue is "empiricism without the dogmas"; Strawson holds the given is public (bodies, persons), not private sense-data.
- **B:** False proposition: "Both abandon empiricism as irredeemable and ground knowledge in rationalist first principles." Correct replacement: "Quine retains empirical constraint, unlike Strawson's rejection of the private given." Rationale: The option overstates their break with empiricism and invents a rationalist foundation. Quine retains empirical constraint without the two dogmas, while Strawson replaces private sense-data with public bodies and persons.

- **C:** False proposition: "Both take private sense-data as the basic given." Correct replacement: "Quine retains empirical constraint, unlike Strawson's rejection of the private given." Rationale: This reverses Strawson's central objection and miscasts Quine. Strawson makes publicly identifiable bodies and persons basic, while Quine retains empiricism without granting private sense-data an atomistic foundational role.
- **D:** False proposition: "Quine denies that experience is any check on belief." Correct replacement: "Quine retains empirical constraint, unlike Strawson's rejection of the private given." Rationale: Quine does not remove experience from inquiry; that would abandon empiricism altogether. Experience constrains the web corporately, while Strawson's separate correction locates the given in public bodies and persons rather than private sense-data.

Examiner trap: Printed ownership, two-project map and anti-conflation boundary must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C01 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C01.

PYQ linkage: All owned questions; use the ownership table before comparison.

MCQ 5

Quine's precise conclusion about the analytic/synthetic distinction is that:

A. There is no principled, non-circular criterion marking off a class of analytic truths. B. No sentence has ever appeared analytic to any competent speaker. C. All meaningful sentence is analytic once translated into canonical logical notation. D. Analyticity is identical with logical truth and therefore needs no account of synonymy.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "There is no principled, non-circular criterion marking off a class of analytic truths." Rationale: Quine denies a non-circular boundary, not the appearance of analyticity; logical truths are only one part of the alleged analytic class.
- **B:** False proposition: "No sentence has ever appeared analytic to any competent speaker." Correct replacement: "There is no principled, non-circular criterion marking off a class of analytic truths." Rationale: This overstates Quine's conclusion. He does not deny that competent speakers recognize familiar apparent examples; he denies a principled, non-circular boundary for the alleged analytic class.
- **C:** False proposition: "All meaningful sentence is analytic once translated into canonical logical notation." Correct replacement: "There is no principled, non-circular criterion marking off a class of analytic truths." Rationale: Regimentation does not turn every meaningful sentence into an analytic truth. Quine's complaint is that canonical notation supplies no non-circular criterion separating an alleged analytic class from synthetic statements.
- **D:** False proposition: "Analyticity is identical with logical truth and therefore needs no account of synonymy." Correct replacement: "There is no principled, non-circular criterion marking off a class of analytic truths." Rationale: This wrongly collapses analyticity into logical truth. The alleged analytic

class also includes truths said to depend on synonymy, and Quine argues that synonymy itself lacks the required non-circular explanation.

Examiner trap: Analyticity, synonymy, definition, interchangeability and semantical rules must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C02 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), 2019 Q1(e), 2024 Q4(c).

MCQ 6

Interchangeability *salva veritate* fails to define synonymy because:

A. It is explicitly defined in terms of definition, which is circular. B. It cannot be expressed in any formal language. C. It already presupposes translation indeterminacy, so synonymy cannot be compared across languages. D. Coextensive terms interchange extensionally, and adding necessity presupposes analyticity.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "It is explicitly defined in terms of definition, which is circular." Correct replacement: "Coextensive terms interchange extensionally, and adding necessity presupposes analyticity." Rationale: This wrongly treats interchangeability as explicitly defined through definition. Its real problem is that coextensive terms substitute extensionally, while restricting substitution by necessity reintroduces analyticity.
- **B:** False proposition: "It cannot be expressed in any formal language." Correct replacement: "Coextensive terms interchange extensionally, and adding necessity presupposes analyticity." Rationale: The test can be expressed formally, so inexpressibility is not the objection. It fails because extensional interchangeability over-generates, and an intensional repair presupposes the analyticity under analysis.
- **C:** False proposition: "It already presupposes translation indeterminacy, so synonymy cannot be compared across languages." Correct replacement: "Coextensive terms interchange extensionally, and adding necessity presupposes analyticity." Rationale: This wrongly makes translation indeterminacy across languages the presupposition. *Salva-veritate* interchangeability fails within a language because coextension is too weak and necessity would presuppose analyticity.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Coextensive terms interchange extensionally, and adding necessity presupposes analyticity." Rationale: Extensional interchangeability over-generates; adding necessity to repair it reintroduces the very notion (analyticity) under analysis.

Examiner trap: Analyticity, synonymy, definition, interchangeability and semantical rules must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C02 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), 2019 Q1(e), 2024 Q4(c).

MCQ 7

Quine regards the appeal to "semantic rules" in an artificial language as inadequate because such rules:

A. They generate contradictions whenever an artificial language classifies a sentence as analytic. B. They merely stipulate which sentences count as analytic and leave analyticity itself unexplained. C. They cannot be formulated for artificial languages without presupposing natural-language meaning. D. They presuppose a completed radical-translation manual before analyticity can be stipulated.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "They generate contradictions whenever an artificial language classifies a sentence as analytic." Correct replacement: "They merely stipulate which sentences count as analytic and leave analyticity itself unexplained." Rationale: Quine does not claim that semantic rules generate contradictions. His objection is explanatory: listing analytic sentences by stipulation fixes an extension but leaves the general concept of analyticity unexplained.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "They merely stipulate which sentences count as analytic and leave analyticity itself unexplained." Rationale: Listing analytic sentences by fiat specifies an extension, not the concept of analyticity.
- **C:** False proposition: "They cannot be formulated for artificial languages without presupposing natural-language meaning." Correct replacement: "They merely stipulate which sentences count as analytic and leave analyticity itself unexplained." Rationale: This confuses formulability with explanatory adequacy. Artificial languages can contain explicit semantic rules, but those stipulations do not explain what makes the listed sentences analytic.
- **D:** False proposition: "They presuppose a completed radical-translation manual before analyticity can be stipulated." Correct replacement: "They merely stipulate which sentences count as analytic and leave analyticity itself unexplained." Rationale: Radical translation is irrelevant to this objection and need not precede a stipulation. The failure is that semantic rules merely label sentences analytic without clarifying the concept of analyticity itself.

Examiner trap: Analyticity, synonymy, definition, interchangeability and semantical rules must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C02 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), 2019 Q1(e), 2024 Q4(c).

MCQ 8

The Grice-Strawson reply "In Defence of a Dogma" (1956) contends that:

A. Quine conclusively proved the distinction to be unreal. B. Synonymy can be defined without residue by unrestricted interchangeability *salva veritate*. C. A distinction with agreed use and clear examples is not discredited merely by the absence of a reductive definition. D. Analyticity is identical with empirical verifiability, so agreed usage cannot defend it.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Quine conclusively proved the distinction to be unreal." Correct replacement: "A distinction with agreed use and clear examples is not discredited merely by the absence of a reductive definition." Rationale: This reverses the Grice-Strawson reply. They argue that stable ordinary use and agreed examples support the distinction despite Quine's demand for a reductive or behavioural boundary.
- **B:** False proposition: "Synonymy can be defined without residue by unrestricted interchangeability *salva veritate*." Correct replacement: "A distinction with agreed use and clear examples is not discredited merely by the absence of a reductive definition." Rationale: The reply does not claim that unrestricted substitution fully defines synonymy; coextensive expressions defeat that test. Grice and Strawson instead defend the distinction through established use and clear cases.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "A distinction with agreed use and clear examples is not discredited merely by the absence of a reductive definition." Rationale: They defend the distinction's reality via ordinary use; Quine replies this lacks the principled behavioural boundary logical empiricism required.
- **D:** False proposition: "Analyticity is identical with empirical verifiability, so agreed usage cannot defend it." Correct replacement: "A distinction with agreed use and clear examples is not discredited merely by the absence of a reductive definition." Rationale: This conflates analyticity with the empiricist verification criterion. Grice and Strawson appeal to agreed linguistic practice to defend analytic-synthetic usage, while Quine still demands a principled boundary.

Examiner trap: Analyticity, synonymy, definition, interchangeability and semantical rules must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C02 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), 2019 Q1(e), 2024 Q4(c).

MCQ 9

The second dogma, reductionism, is the belief that:

A. All statements are analytic once the total language is regimented into canonical notation. B. Reductionism says that word meaning is exhausted by linguistic use, and that each sentence inherits confirmation from established communal practice rather than immediate experience. C. Reference is inscrutable, so individual statements cannot possess determinate confirmation conditions. D. Each meaningful statement is equivalent to a logical construction upon terms referring to immediate experience, with its own range of confirming experiences.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "All statements are analytic once the total language is regimented into canonical notation." Correct replacement: "Each meaningful statement is equivalent to a logical construction upon terms referring to immediate experience, with its own range of confirming experiences." Rationale: The claim that all statements become analytic in canonical notation confuses the second dogma with regimentation. Reductionism instead assigns each sentence its own experiential construction and confirmation conditions.
- **B:** False proposition: "Reductionism says that word meaning is exhausted by linguistic use, and that each sentence inherits confirmation from established communal practice rather than immediate experience." Correct replacement: "Each meaningful statement is equivalent to a logical construction upon terms referring to immediate experience, with its own range of confirming experiences." Rationale: The option substitutes a use-based account of meaning for reductionism. The dogma instead treats each sentence as reducible to immediate experience with independently specifiable confirmation conditions.
- **C:** False proposition: "Reference is inscrutable, so individual statements cannot possess determinate confirmation conditions." Correct replacement: "Each meaningful statement is equivalent to a logical construction upon terms referring to immediate experience, with its own range of confirming experiences." Rationale: This states a later Quinean challenge rather than the dogma he attacks. Reductionism positively assumes determinate, sentence-specific confirmation conditions grounded in immediate experience.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Each meaningful statement is equivalent to a logical construction upon terms referring to immediate experience, with its own range of confirming experiences." Rationale: Radical reductionism is individual verificationism: each sentence is assigned its own private confirmation-conditions.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 10

In Quine's metaphor, the "web of belief" meets experience:

- A. The web meets experience sentence by sentence, with each claim independently confirmed or refuted.
B. Only as a corporate body, and only at its edges / boundary conditions. C. The web not meets experience, because observation has no evidential role in Quine's naturalism. D. The web meets experience only through an unrevisable class of analytic statements.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The web meets experience sentence by sentence, with each claim independently confirmed or refuted." Correct replacement: "Only as a corporate body, and only at its edges / boundary conditions." Rationale: This restates the atomistic reductionism that confirmation holism rejects. The web faces experience as a corporate body, with sensory pressure entering at the periphery rather than testing each sentence independently.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Only as a corporate body, and only at its edges / boundary conditions." Rationale: Confirmation holism: the total field faces the tribunal of experience as a whole; only the periphery touches experience directly.
- **C:** False proposition: "The web not meets experience, because observation has no evidential role in Quine's naturalism." Correct replacement: "Only as a corporate body, and only at its edges / boundary conditions." Rationale: The option turns holism into evidential nihilism. Observation still constrains Quine's system through its experiential boundary; what he denies is isolated sentence-by-sentence testing.
- **D:** False proposition: "The web meets experience only through an unrevisable class of analytic statements." Correct replacement: "Only as a corporate body, and only at its edges / boundary conditions." Rationale: This reintroduces the unrevisable analytic class that Quine rejects. Experience impinges on the web's periphery, and revisions can in principle reach any statement in the corporate system.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 11

"No statement is immune to revision" implies, for Quine, that:

A. The laws of logic are the one exception and cannot be revised. B. Only observation sentences are revisable, and central logical and mathematical claims remain immune. C. Even the laws of logic could in principle be revised to conserve the rest of the system. D. Only analytic truths are revisable, since synthetic claims are fixed directly by experience.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The laws of logic are the one exception and cannot be revised." Correct replacement: "Even the laws of logic could in principle be revised to conserve the rest of the system." Rationale: Calling the laws of logic an unrevisable exception directly contradicts Quine. Minimum mutilation explains their exceptional resistance to change, not an immunity in principle.
- **B:** False proposition: "Only observation sentences are revisable, and central logical and mathematical claims remain immune." Correct replacement: "Even the laws of logic could in principle be revised to conserve the rest of the system." Rationale: The option mistakes practical

centrality for categorical immunity. Observation sentences are easier to revise, but even logical and mathematical claims remain revisable in principle under minimum mutilation.

- **C:** Correct proposition: "Even the laws of logic could in principle be revised to conserve the rest of the system." Rationale: Holism extends revisability to logic itself, though logic is surrendered only under great pressure, by minimum mutilation.
- **D:** False proposition: "Only analytic truths are revisable, since synthetic claims are fixed directly by experience." Correct replacement: "Even the laws of logic could in principle be revised to conserve the rest of the system." Rationale: This reverses both holism and the rejected analytic-synthetic picture. Synthetic claims are not fixed one by one by experience, and Quine's revisability reaches even logic, constrained only pragmatically by minimum mutilation.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 12

The contrast between "central" and "peripheral" statements in the web is one of:

A. Central and peripheral statements differ in practical entrenchment, not in unrevisable kind. B. Central statements are true, and peripheral statements become false whenever experience conflicts. C. Centrality vindicates the analytic-synthetic division as a sharp distinction within Quine's own theory. D. Central statements are meaningful, and peripheral statements become meaningless under recalcitrant experience.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Central and peripheral statements differ in practical entrenchment, not in unrevisable kind." Rationale: After the analytic-synthetic foundation fails, centrality and entrenchment explain differential practical revisability within the web; they do not redefine analyticity.
- **B:** False proposition: "Central statements are true, and peripheral statements become false whenever experience conflicts." Correct replacement: "Central and peripheral statements differ in practical entrenchment, not in unrevisable kind." Rationale: The option confuses location in the web with truth value. Central claims are more entrenched, while recalcitrant experience prompts a choice of revisions rather than automatically making every peripheral statement false.
- **C:** False proposition: "Centrality vindicates the analytic-synthetic division as a sharp distinction within Quine's own theory." Correct replacement: "Central and peripheral statements differ in practical entrenchment, not in unrevisable kind." Rationale: This wrongly turns a difference of degree into the sharp boundary Quine rejects. Centrality marks practical entrenchment and differential revisability; it does not redefine analyticity.

- **D:** False proposition: "Central statements are meaningful, and peripheral statements become meaningless under recalcitrant experience." Correct replacement: "Central and peripheral statements differ in practical entrenchment, not in unrevisable kind." Rationale: Meaningfulness is not what distinguishes the centre from the periphery. The contrast concerns how resistant statements are to revision, and experiential conflict does not make peripheral claims meaningless.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 13

Given (H & A) $\rightarrow$ O and not-O, what is the strongest conclusion licensed by modus tollens in the Duhem-Quine setting?

A. The focal hypothesis H alone is false, regardless of whether any auxiliary assumption is retained. B. The auxiliary assumptions A alone are false, so the focal hypothesis H remains confirmed. C. H and A cannot both be retained, and not-O does not show which conjunct must be revised. D. Both H and A are confirmed because the failed observation leaves the theoretical package untouched.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The focal hypothesis H alone is false, regardless of whether any auxiliary assumption is retained." Correct replacement: "H and A cannot both be retained, and not-O does not show which conjunct must be revised." Rationale: Inferring that the focal hypothesis alone is false commits the formal error of deriving not-H from not-(H and A). Modus tollens falsifies only the conjunction and leaves the revision underdetermined.
- **B:** False proposition: "The auxiliary assumptions A alone are false, so the focal hypothesis H remains confirmed." Correct replacement: "H and A cannot both be retained, and not-O does not show which conjunct must be revised." Rationale: The inference to not-A alone is no better than the inference to not-H alone. The failed prediction shows that H and A cannot both be retained, but leaves the locus of revision underdetermined.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "H and A cannot both be retained, and not-O does not show which conjunct must be revised." Rationale: Modus tollens establishes only that the conjunction of hypothesis and auxiliaries is false. It leaves underdetermined whether H, A or some component within A should be revised.
- **D:** False proposition: "Both H and A are confirmed because the failed observation leaves the theoretical package untouched." Correct replacement: "H and A cannot both be retained, and not-O does not show which conjunct must be revised." Rationale: This reverses the logical consequence of the failed observation. Not-O falsifies the conjunction of H and A; it confirms neither conjunct, although it leaves underdetermined which one to abandon.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 14

How do Duhem's and Quine's versions of the thesis differ?

A. Duhem and Quine give the thesis exactly the same scope, including logic and mathematics. B. Quine restricts it to physics and Duhem extends it to all knowledge. C. Duhem restricts the thesis to physics, and Quine extends holism to science as a whole, including logic. D. Both exempt logic and mathematics, limiting underdetermination to empirical hypotheses and auxiliaries.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Duhem and Quine give the thesis exactly the same scope, including logic and mathematics." Correct replacement: "Duhem restricts the thesis to physics, and Quine extends holism to science as a whole, including logic." Rationale: This erases the decisive difference of scope. Duhem confines the thesis to theoretical physics, whereas Quine extends holism across science and, controversially, to logic and mathematics.
- **B:** False proposition: "Quine restricts it to physics and Duhem extends it to all knowledge." Correct replacement: "Duhem restricts the thesis to physics, and Quine extends holism to science as a whole, including logic." Rationale: The historical attribution is reversed. Duhem restricts underdetermination to physics; Quine broadens the web to knowledge as a whole, including possible revision of logic.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Duhem restricts the thesis to physics, and Quine extends holism to science as a whole, including logic." Rationale: Scope is the key difference; Quine's extension to logic is the controversial step that drives the analytic/synthetic collapse.
- **D:** False proposition: "Both exempt logic and mathematics, limiting underdetermination to empirical hypotheses and auxiliaries." Correct replacement: "Duhem restricts the thesis to physics, and Quine extends holism to science as a whole, including logic." Rationale: This transfers Duhem's restriction to Quine. Duhem exempts logic and mathematics, but Quine's enlarged holism includes them within the revisable scientific web.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 15

The Neptune and Vulcan episodes together illustrate that:

A. Revising an auxiliary is invariably the correct response to an anomaly. B. Revising the deep law is invariably the correct response. C. Newtonian mechanics is unrevisable in principle, so anomalies must invariably be assigned to auxiliaries. D. Neptune prompted auxiliary revision, Mercury deep-law revision, and logic fixes neither.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Revising an auxiliary is invariably the correct response to an anomaly." Correct replacement: "Neptune prompted auxiliary revision, Mercury deep-law revision, and logic fixes neither." Rationale: The word 'invariably' is defeated by the Vulcan failure. Neptune vindicated revising an auxiliary, but Mercury's anomaly ultimately required replacing Newtonian gravitation with general relativity.
- **B:** False proposition: "Revising the deep law is invariably the correct response." Correct replacement: "Neptune prompted auxiliary revision, Mercury deep-law revision, and logic fixes neither." Rationale: This overgeneralizes the Mercury case and ignores Neptune. Sometimes an anomaly is resolved by revising an auxiliary; logic alone does not always direct us to the deep law.
- **C:** False proposition: "Newtonian mechanics is unrevisable in principle, so anomalies must invariably be assigned to auxiliaries." Correct replacement: "Neptune prompted auxiliary revision, Mercury deep-law revision, and logic fixes neither." Rationale: This wrongly makes Newtonian mechanics unrevisable and assigns every anomaly to auxiliaries. The Vulcan hypothesis failed, and general relativity supplied the successful deep-law revision.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Neptune prompted auxiliary revision, Mercury deep-law revision, and logic fixes neither." Rationale: Neptune vindicated auxiliary revision; Vulcan failed and the correct fix was general relativity - opposite responses, identical logic.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 16

Popper's response to the Duhem-Quine point is best described as:

A. Popper denies the logical force of the Duhem-Quine problem and treats isolated hypotheses as conclusively falsifiable. B. Popper accepts the thesis as establishing sceptical relativism and abandons methodological rules for theory choice. C. Popper accepts the logical problem and treats falsification as a methodological decision that forbids ad hoc rescues. D. A reduction of scientific method to individual psychology.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Popper denies the logical force of the Duhem-Quine problem and treats isolated hypotheses as conclusively falsifiable." Correct replacement: "Popper accepts the logical problem and treats falsification as a methodological decision that forbids ad hoc rescues." Rationale: This misstates Popper's response. He accepts that isolated hypotheses are not conclusively falsified by logic alone, then imposes methodological rules against ad hoc protective revisions.
- **B:** False proposition: "Popper accepts the thesis as establishing sceptical relativism and abandons methodological rules for theory choice." Correct replacement: "Popper accepts the logical problem and treats falsification as a methodological decision that forbids ad hoc rescues." Rationale: Popper does not infer sceptical relativism from logical underdetermination. He preserves criticism through methodological decisions about test statements and rules that forbid ad hoc rescues.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Popper accepts the logical problem and treats falsification as a methodological decision that forbids ad hoc rescues." Rationale: Popper concedes the logic and adds methodological rules; Lakatos develops this into hard core / protective belt research programmes.
- **D:** False proposition: "A reduction of scientific method to individual psychology." Correct replacement: "Popper accepts the logical problem and treats falsification as a methodological decision that forbids ad hoc rescues." Rationale: This confuses Popper's methodology with Quinean naturalization. Popper answers the logical problem by regulating falsification practices, not by reducing scientific method to individual psychology.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 17

In the "Gavagai" scenario, why can the field linguist not settle whether the term means "rabbit" or "undetached rabbit-parts"?

A. Radical translation fails because native speakers withhold assent and deliberately frustrate behavioural testing. B. Rapid rabbit movement prevents sufficiently stable observation to discriminate among rival translation manuals. C. Both manuals fit stimulus meaning, and behavioural evidence does not fix the required apparatus of individuation. D. Reference remains unsettled only because the linguist lacks a bilingual dictionary linking native terms to English objects.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Radical translation fails because native speakers withhold assent and deliberately frustrate behavioural testing." Correct replacement: "Both manuals fit stimulus meaning, and behavioural evidence does not fix the required apparatus of individuation." Rationale: The indeterminacy does not arise from native non-cooperation. Even complete assent and dissent behaviour can fit both translations because stimulus meaning does not determine an apparatus of object individuation.
- **B:** False proposition: "Rapid rabbit movement prevents sufficiently stable observation to discriminate among rival translation manuals." Correct replacement: "Both manuals fit stimulus meaning, and behavioural evidence does not fix the required apparatus of individuation." Rationale: This treats a conceptual underdetermination as a practical observation problem. Stable rabbit sightings still support 'rabbit' and 'undetached rabbit-part' equally unless an individuation apparatus is already assumed.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Both manuals fit stimulus meaning, and behavioural evidence does not fix the required apparatus of individuation." Rationale: The rival translations share stimulus meaning; the "same gavagai?" question presupposes the very individuation apparatus under investigation.
- **D:** False proposition: "Reference remains unsettled only because the linguist lacks a bilingual dictionary linking native terms to English objects." Correct replacement: "Both manuals fit stimulus meaning, and behavioural evidence does not fix the required apparatus of individuation." Rationale: Lacking a bilingual dictionary linking native terms to English objects is merely the setup, not the explanation. Complete behavioural evidence can still fit rival schemes of individuation.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 18

"Inscrutability of reference" and "indeterminacy of translation" are related in that:

A. Inscrutability concerns the reference of terms, and it supports the wider indeterminacy among whole translation manuals. B. They are interchangeable names for the same claim that reference and translation lack determinate content. C. The theses are opposed: inscrutability fixes term-reference uniquely, and translation indeterminacy denies any acceptable whole-sentence manual. D. Both theses eliminate stimulus meaning altogether, so assent and dissent place no constraint on translation.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Inscrutability concerns the reference of terms, and it supports the wider indeterminacy among whole translation manuals." Rationale: Reference of sub-sentential terms is undetermined; rival analytical hypotheses generate whole manuals with no fact of the matter between them.

- **B:** False proposition: "They are interchangeable names for the same claim that reference and translation lack determinate content." Correct replacement: "Inscrutability concerns the reference of terms, and it supports the wider indeterminacy among whole translation manuals." Rationale: This conflates two levels of Quine's argument. Inscrutability concerns what sub-sentential terms refer to, whereas indeterminacy concerns rival whole translation manuals supported by the same evidence.
- **C:** False proposition: "The theses are opposed: inscrutability fixes term-reference uniquely, and translation indeterminacy denies any acceptable whole-sentence manual." Correct replacement: "Inscrutability concerns the reference of terms, and it supports the wider indeterminacy among whole translation manuals." Rationale: Both clauses are reversed. Inscrutability denies unique term-reference, and translation indeterminacy permits multiple acceptable manuals rather than denying every whole-sentence translation.
- **D:** False proposition: "Both theses eliminate stimulus meaning altogether, so assent and dissent place no constraint on translation." Correct replacement: "Inscrutability concerns the reference of terms, and it supports the wider indeterminacy among whole translation manuals." Rationale: This overstates the theses by removing all behavioural constraint. Stimulus meaning still constrains observation sentences; it simply does not fix term-reference or choose uniquely among whole manuals.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 19

Which premise does Quine himself acknowledge as driving the indeterminacy argument in the special case of language?

A. Innate meanings supplied by rationalist psychology determine which translation manual is correct. B. Cartesian substance dualism explains why public behaviour cannot reveal a speaker's private meanings. C. Behaviourism about the evidence for meaning - in linguistics, he says, "one has no choice". D. The analytic-synthetic distinction guarantees determinate synonymy across rival translation manuals.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Innate meanings supplied by rationalist psychology determine which translation manual is correct." Correct replacement: "Behaviourism about the evidence for meaning - in linguistics, he says, 'one has no choice'." Rationale: This substitutes a rationalist semantic guarantee for Quine's naturalism. His acknowledged premise is that evidence for meaning consists in public verbal behaviour, not innate meanings that select a manual.
- **B:** False proposition: "Cartesian substance dualism explains why public behaviour cannot reveal a speaker's private meanings." Correct replacement: "Behaviourism about the evidence for meaning - in linguistics, he says, 'one has no choice'." Rationale: Cartesian substance dualism and inaccessible

private meanings are not Quine's premise. His argument proceeds from publicly observable verbal dispositions as the available evidence for meaning.

- **C:** Correct proposition: "Behaviourism about the evidence for meaning - in linguistics, he says, "one has no choice"." Rationale: The evidence for meaning is public verbal behaviour; the force of the argument tracks this behaviourist premise about evidence.
- **D:** False proposition: "The analytic-synthetic distinction guarantees determinate synonymy across rival translation manuals." Correct replacement: "Behaviourism about the evidence for meaning - in linguistics, he says, "one has no choice"." Rationale: This invokes the very analytic-synthetic guarantee Quine contests. Indeterminacy is driven instead by the behaviourist constraint that linguistic evidence is public verbal behaviour.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 20

Chomsky's objection to the indeterminacy of translation is that:

A. Meanings are Platonic abstract objects that select one correct translation independently of behaviour. B. Indeterminacy is merely the ordinary underdetermination of theory by evidence that also affects physics, so Quine owes a special argument for treating meaning worse than physical theory. C. Translation is fully determinate whenever all observable verbal dispositions have been recorded. D. Stimulus meaning is incoherent, so no behavioural evidence can constrain translation at all.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Meanings are Platonic abstract objects that select one correct translation independently of behaviour." Correct replacement: "Indeterminacy is merely the ordinary underdetermination of theory by evidence that also affects physics, so Quine owes a special argument for treating meaning worse than physical theory." Rationale: This attributes a Platonic theory of meaning that is not Chomsky's stated objection here. His criticism compares translation with normal scientific underdetermination and challenges Quine's asymmetry between physics and meaning.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Indeterminacy is merely the ordinary underdetermination of theory by evidence that also affects physics, so Quine owes a special argument for treating meaning worse than physical theory." Rationale: Chomsky assimilates it to normal underdetermination; the burden falls on Quine to justify the asymmetry he posits between physics and meaning.
- **C:** False proposition: "Translation is fully determinate whenever all observable verbal dispositions have been recorded." Correct replacement: "Indeterminacy is merely the ordinary underdetermination of theory by evidence that also affects physics, so Quine owes a special

argument for treating meaning worse than physical theory." Rationale: Recording all observable verbal dispositions does not make translation fully determinate. Chomsky instead argues that residual plurality resembles ordinary underdetermination in physics.

- **D:** False proposition: "Stimulus meaning is incoherent, so no behavioural evidence can constrain translation at all." Correct replacement: "Indeterminacy is merely the ordinary underdetermination of theory by evidence that also affects physics, so Quine owes a special argument for treating meaning worse than physical theory." Rationale: This eliminates evidence rather than comparing its underdetermining role across domains. Chomsky's objection allows behavioural constraints but asks why their incompleteness makes meaning less determinate than physical theory.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 21

Quine's criterion of ontological commitment is captured in the slogan:

A. "To be is to be perceived," because ontology reduces to the contents of experience. B. "The meaning of a word is its use," because ontological commitment follows ordinary linguistic practice. C. "To be is to be the value of a bound variable," from "On What There Is," published in 1948. D. "Existence is a real predicate," because quantified theory attributes existence as an ordinary property.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "'To be is to be perceived,' because ontology reduces to the contents of experience." Correct replacement: "'To be is to be the value of a bound variable,' from 'On What There Is,' published in 1948." Rationale: "To be is to be perceived" and reducing ontology to experiential contents are Berkeleian, not Quinean. Quine reads commitment from the bound variables of a regimented theory.
- **B:** False proposition: "'The meaning of a word is its use,' because ontological commitment follows ordinary linguistic practice." Correct replacement: "'To be is to be the value of a bound variable,' from 'On What There Is,' published in 1948." Rationale: The slogan is Wittgensteinian and concerns meaning, not Quinean ontology. Quine locates commitment in the bound variables of a regimented theory, not in ordinary linguistic practice.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "'To be is to be the value of a bound variable,' from 'On What There Is,' published in 1948." Rationale: A theory is committed to the entities its bound variables must range over; note the slogan is from "On What There Is" (1948), not "Two Dogmas" (1951).
- **D:** False proposition: "'Existence is a real predicate,' because quantified theory attributes existence as an ordinary property." Correct replacement: "'To be is to be the value of a bound variable,' from 'On What There Is,' published in 1948." Rationale: This mistakes existence for an ordinary first-order

property. Quine expresses existence through quantification: a theory is committed to whatever values its bound variables require.

Examiner trap: Ontological commitment, canonical notation, indispensability and naturalized epistemology must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C04 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), with bounded system-enrichment only.

MCQ 22

"Naturalized epistemology" is Quine's proposal that:

A. Epistemology becomes a branch of ethics concerned chiefly with prescribing duties of belief. B. Naturalized epistemology concedes global scepticism and treats knowledge as impossible in principle. C. Epistemology becomes empirical psychology rather than an a priori foundation for science. D. Only a priori methods can yield genuine knowledge.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Epistemology becomes a branch of ethics concerned chiefly with prescribing duties of belief." Correct replacement: "Epistemology becomes empirical psychology rather than an a priori foundation for science." Rationale: This substitutes a normative ethics of belief for Quine's proposed naturalization. He relocates epistemology within empirical psychology to study how sensory input produces theoretical output.
- **B:** False proposition: "Naturalized epistemology concedes global scepticism and treats knowledge as impossible in principle." Correct replacement: "Epistemology becomes empirical psychology rather than an a priori foundation for science." Rationale: Naturalized epistemology does not concede that knowledge is impossible. It abandons an external foundation and studies cognition from within continuous scientific inquiry.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Epistemology becomes empirical psychology rather than an a priori foundation for science." Rationale: From "Epistemology Naturalized" (1968/69): philosophy is continuous with science, not its prior tribunal; study how sensory input yields theory.
- **D:** False proposition: "Only a priori methods can yield genuine knowledge." Correct replacement: "Epistemology becomes empirical psychology rather than an a priori foundation for science." Rationale: The claim that only a priori methods yield genuine knowledge directly reverses Quine's naturalism. He replaces first philosophy with empirical study of sensory input and theory.

Examiner trap: Ontological commitment, canonical notation, indispensability and naturalized epistemology must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C04 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), with bounded system-enrichment only.

MCQ 23

"Ontological relativity" is the thesis that:

A. All ontology is equally unacceptable, since reference cannot be fixed relative to any background language. B. What a theory is about is determinate only relative to a background language or translation manual. C. Ontology is fixed absolutely by formal logic, independently of all background language or translation manual. D. Ontological relativity implies that no objects exist, even relative to a background theory or language.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "All ontology is equally unacceptable, since reference cannot be fixed relative to any background language." Correct replacement: "What a theory is about is determinate only relative to a background language or translation manual." Rationale: This turns relativity into blanket rejection. Reference can be fixed relative to a background language or manual; Quine denies only a theory-independent standpoint from which all reference is fixed absolutely.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "What a theory is about is determinate only relative to a background language or translation manual." Rationale: Reference is relative to a background manual; "at home" we acquiesce in our mother tongue and take it at face value.
- **C:** False proposition: "Ontology is fixed absolutely by formal logic, independently of all background language or translation manual." Correct replacement: "What a theory is about is determinate only relative to a background language or translation manual." Rationale: Formal logic does not supply an absolute ontology independently of interpretation. What the variables range over is intelligible only relative to a background language or translation manual.
- **D:** False proposition: "Ontological relativity implies that no objects exist, even relative to a background theory or language." Correct replacement: "What a theory is about is determinate only relative to a background language or translation manual." Rationale: This conflates ontological relativity with nihilism. Objects and reference remain available within a background theory; the thesis denies absolute, framework-free determination.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 24

The convergence between Quine and the later Wittgenstein is best stated as:

A. Quine and Wittgenstein reject private meanings through indeterminacy and meaning-as-use respectively. B. Both defend a principled analytic-synthetic distinction against verificationist reductions of meaning. C. Both are foundationalists who seek an unrevisable basis for knowledge outside ordinary inquiry. D. Both accept private ostensive definition as sufficient to fix the meaning of sensation terms.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Quine and Wittgenstein reject private meanings through indeterminacy and meaning-as-use respectively." Rationale: They converge on anti-private-meaning holism, though Quine reforms language (regimentation) while Wittgenstein describes it ("in order as it is").
- **B:** False proposition: "Both defend a principled analytic-synthetic distinction against verificationist reductions of meaning." Correct replacement: "Quine and Wittgenstein reject private meanings through indeterminacy and meaning-as-use respectively." Rationale: Quine explicitly attacks a principled analytic-synthetic boundary, so this cannot be their convergence. Their shared direction is anti-private meaning, though Wittgenstein leaves language 'in order as it is.'
- **C:** False proposition: "Both are foundationalists who seek an unrevisable basis for knowledge outside ordinary inquiry." Correct replacement: "Quine and Wittgenstein reject private meanings through indeterminacy and meaning-as-use respectively." Rationale: Calling both thinkers foundationalists seeking an unrevisable basis assigns the position they resist. Quine works within a revisable web, while Wittgenstein describes public linguistic practice.
- **D:** False proposition: "Both accept private ostensive definition as sufficient to fix the meaning of sensation terms." Correct replacement: "Quine and Wittgenstein reject private meanings through indeterminacy and meaning-as-use respectively." Rationale: The claim reverses their anti-private orientation. Wittgenstein denies that private ostension can fix sensation language, and Quine likewise makes linguistic evidence publicly behavioural.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.

MCQ 25

For Strawson, a "basic particular" is one that:

- A. A basic particular is metaphysically simple, indivisible and indestructible in the manner of a substance. B. Is a private sense-datum given in immediate experience. C. A basic particular exists with absolute necessity and belongs to all possible worlds. D. A basic particular can be identified independently of first identifying another particular.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "A basic particular is metaphysically simple, indivisible and indestructible in the manner of a substance." Correct replacement: "A basic particular can be identified independently of first identifying another particular." Rationale: This imports a classical substance notion that Strawson's definition does not require. 'Basic' concerns identification-independence, not metaphysical simplicity, indivisibility or indestructibility.
- **B:** False proposition: "Is a private sense-datum given in immediate experience." Correct replacement: "A basic particular can be identified independently of first identifying another particular." Rationale: A private sense-datum cannot serve as the public anchor Strawson requires. Basic particulars are independently identifiable within a shared spatio-temporal framework.
- **C:** False proposition: "A basic particular exists with absolute necessity and belongs to all possible worlds." Correct replacement: "A basic particular can be identified independently of first identifying another particular." Rationale: This confuses conceptual priority with modal necessity. A basic particular need not exist in every possible world; it is basic because its identification does not depend on first identifying another particular.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "A basic particular can be identified independently of first identifying another particular." Rationale: "Basic" is a claim of identification-independence (conceptual dependence), not of simplicity or necessity.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 26

Strawson's argument that material bodies are basic turns crucially on:

A. Material bodies are basic because their causal powers produce sensations more directly than other particulars. B. Objective thought requires re-identification within one public spatio-temporal system of material bodies. C. Material bodies are basic because they are the objects most immediately given in private perception. D. Material bodies are basic because infinite divisibility supplies an unlimited basis for identification.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Material bodies are basic because their causal powers produce sensations more directly than other particulars." Correct replacement: "Objective thought requires re-identification within one public spatio-temporal system of material bodies." Rationale: Causal production of sensations is not Strawson's criterion of basicness. Material bodies are basic because they support identification and re-identification within one public spatio-temporal system.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Objective thought requires re-identification within one public spatio-temporal system of material bodies." Rationale: Re-identification ("the same one again") requires one public space-time, and bodies are what compose that framework.

- **C:** False proposition: "Material bodies are basic because they are the objects most immediately given in private perception." Correct replacement: "Objective thought requires re-identification within one public spatio-temporal system of material bodies." Rationale: This reintroduces the private-given model Strawson rejects. Bodies are basic through public re-identification in space-time, not because they are immediately presented to a private perceiver.
- **D:** False proposition: "Material bodies are basic because infinite divisibility supplies an unlimited basis for identification." Correct replacement: "Objective thought requires re-identification within one public spatio-temporal system of material bodies." Rationale: Infinite divisibility has no role in the identification argument. What matters is the stable placement and re-identification of material bodies in a common public space-time.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 27

The "no-space" (purely auditory) world thought experiment is designed to show that:

A. Sounds themselves are basic particulars because auditory recurrence requires no spatial framework. B. The thought experiment proves that objective experience is impossible in all non-spatial worlds. C. The auditory world permits re-identification solely by constructing a space-analogue, which confirms the need for a spatio-temporal framework. D. The thought experiment shows that space is a subjective illusion imposed upon purely auditory experience.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Sounds themselves are basic particulars because auditory recurrence requires no spatial framework." Correct replacement: "The auditory world permits re-identification solely by constructing a space-analogue, which confirms the need for a spatio-temporal framework." Rationale: The option ignores the condition needed to identify a recurring sound as the same one. The auditory world supports re-identification only by introducing a master-sound or comparable spatial analogue.
- **B:** False proposition: "The thought experiment proves that objective experience is impossible in all non-spatial worlds." Correct replacement: "The auditory world permits re-identification solely by constructing a space-analogue, which confirms the need for a spatio-temporal framework." Rationale: This overstates the experiment as proving objective experience impossible in every non-spatial world. A master-sound can organize auditory relations and recreate the functional role of space.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "The auditory world permits re-identification solely by constructing a space-analogue, which confirms the need for a spatio-temporal framework." Rationale: The auditory world can support re-identification only by reintroducing a space-substitute (the "master-sound"), which

supports Strawson's thesis.

- **D:** False proposition: "The thought experiment shows that space is a subjective illusion imposed upon purely auditory experience." Correct replacement: "The auditory world permits re-identification solely by constructing a space-analogue, which confirms the need for a spatio-temporal framework." Rationale: The claim that space is a subjective illusion misstates the experiment. It shows that re-identification requires a structured spatial analogue, represented by the master-sound.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 28

"Descriptive" as opposed to "revisionary" metaphysics is best defined as metaphysics that:

A. Descriptive metaphysics rejects metaphysics and confines philosophy to piecemeal linguistic clarification. B. Constructs an ideal logical language to replace ordinary speech. C. Lays bare the actual structure of our conceptual scheme rather than proposing a better one. D. Revises ordinary concepts to suit the needs of natural science.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Descriptive metaphysics rejects metaphysics and confines philosophy to piecemeal linguistic clarification." Correct replacement: "Lays bare the actual structure of our conceptual scheme rather than proposing a better one." Rationale: This mistakes descriptive metaphysics for anti-metaphysical linguistic therapy. Strawson's project in *Individuals* is genuinely metaphysical because it maps the basic structure of our actual conceptual scheme.
- **B:** False proposition: "Constructs an ideal logical language to replace ordinary speech." Correct replacement: "Lays bare the actual structure of our conceptual scheme rather than proposing a better one." Rationale: Constructing an ideal logical language to replace ordinary speech is revisionary, not descriptive. Strawson instead lays bare the structure implicit in ordinary thought in *Individuals*.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Lays bare the actual structure of our conceptual scheme rather than proposing a better one." Rationale: Descartes, Leibniz and Berkeley are revisionary; Strawson (with Aristotle and Kant) is descriptive - *Individuals* (1959).
- **D:** False proposition: "Revises ordinary concepts to suit the needs of natural science." Correct replacement: "Lays bare the actual structure of our conceptual scheme rather than proposing a better one." Rationale: This defines the revisionary alternative, not Strawson's method. Descriptive metaphysics records the framework we actually use rather than redesigning it for natural science.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 29

To call the concept of a person "primitive" is to hold that it is:

A. Calling person primitive means the concept is vague, pre-scientific and destined for theoretical replacement. B. The concept of a person cannot be analysed into a pure ego plus a body and is logically prior to both. C. The concept of a person is innate and fully present in the mind before any public identification. D. The concept of a person is identical with that of a biological organism described only physically.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Calling person primitive means the concept is vague, pre-scientific and destined for theoretical replacement." Correct replacement: "The concept of a person cannot be analysed into a pure ego plus a body and is logically prior to both." Rationale: Here 'primitive' means logically basic, not vague or scientifically obsolete. Strawson treats mind and body concepts as abstractions from the prior concept of a person.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "The concept of a person cannot be analysed into a pure ego plus a body and is logically prior to both." Rationale: Primitive = unanalysable into mind + body; those concepts are later abstractions from the person concept.
- **C:** False proposition: "The concept of a person is innate and fully present in the mind before any public identification." Correct replacement: "The concept of a person cannot be analysed into a pure ego plus a body and is logically prior to both." Rationale: The claim wrongly equates conceptual primitiveness with innateness and private possession. Strawson's person concept is publicly applicable and irreducible to a separate ego plus body.
- **D:** False proposition: "The concept of a person is identical with that of a biological organism described only physically." Correct replacement: "The concept of a person cannot be analysed into a pure ego plus a body and is logically prior to both." Rationale: Identifying a person with a merely biological organism reduces persons to bodies. Strawson instead treats person as irreducible to a pure ego plus body and as bearer of physical and psychological predicates.

Examiner trap: Persons, m/p predicates, self-/other-ascription, other minds and no-ownership must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C08 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b), 2023 Q4(a), 2026 Q3(a).

MCQ 30

P-predicates differ from M-predicates in that P-predicates are:

- A. P-predicates apply only to inanimate material bodies and describe their publicly observable properties.
B. P-predicates are confined to weight, shape and spatial location, just like M-predicates. C. P-predicates can not be self-ascribed and are known only by observing another person's behaviour. D. P-predicates are ascribed to others through behavioural criteria, and their self-ascription is non-observational.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "P-predicates apply only to inanimate material bodies and describe their publicly observable properties." Correct replacement: "P-predicates are ascribed to others through behavioural criteria, and their self-ascription is non-observational." Rationale: Assigning P-predicates only to inanimate material bodies gives them the wrong subjects. They are psychological predicates of persons, other-ascribed behaviourally and self-ascribed non-observationally.
- **B:** False proposition: "P-predicates are confined to weight, shape and spatial location, just like M-predicates." Correct replacement: "P-predicates are ascribed to others through behavioural criteria, and their self-ascription is non-observational." Rationale: Weight, shape and location are M-predicates, so the option collapses the distinction. P-predicates concern states such as pain or intention and have an asymmetric mode of ascription.
- **C:** False proposition: "P-predicates can not be self-ascribed and are known only by observing another person's behaviour." Correct replacement: "P-predicates are ascribed to others through behavioural criteria, and their self-ascription is non-observational." Rationale: This reverses the first-person side of Strawson's asymmetry. P-predicates are self-ascribed without observing one's behaviour, though other-ascription relies on public behavioural criteria.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "P-predicates are ascribed to others through behavioural criteria, and their self-ascription is non-observational." Rationale: The asymmetry of ascription (others by behaviour, self without observation) is the defining mark of a P-predicate.

Examiner trap: Persons, m/p predicates, self-/other-ascription, other minds and no-ownership must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C08 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b), 2023 Q4(a), 2026 Q3(a).

MCQ 31

The core premise of Strawson's argument for the primitiveness of the person is that:

- A. The body causally produces the mind, making person a compound of two independently identifiable substances. B. Experiences are strictly unowned events, so the concept of a subject can be eliminated without loss. C. Only one's own mind is knowable, so self-ascription requires no capacity to identify other persons. D. Self-ascription of P-predicates is possible only if one can also ascribe them to others.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The body causally produces the mind, making person a compound of two independently identifiable substances." Correct replacement: "Self-ascription of P-predicates is possible only if one can also ascribe them to others." Rationale: Saying the body causally produces the mind and forms a compound of two substances adopts the decomposition Strawson rejects. A person is the single subject of M- and P-predicates.
- **B:** False proposition: "Experiences are strictly unowned events, so the concept of a subject can be eliminated without loss." Correct replacement: "Self-ascription of P-predicates is possible only if one can also ascribe them to others." Rationale: The option repeats the no-ownership view rather than Strawson's premise. Experiences are ascribed to persons, whose identity supports both self- and other-ascription of psychological predicates.
- **C:** False proposition: "Only one's own mind is knowable, so self-ascription requires no capacity to identify other persons." Correct replacement: "Self-ascription of P-predicates is possible only if one can also ascribe them to others." Rationale: Claiming that only one's own mind is knowable and that self-ascription needs no identification of others reverses Strawson's condition. P-predicates must also be applicable to other persons.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Self-ascription of P-predicates is possible only if one can also ascribe them to others." Rationale: Self-ascription requires other-ascription, which requires identifying others as single subjects of both M- and P-predicates.

Examiner trap: Persons, m/p predicates, self-/other-ascription, other minds and no-ownership must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C08 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b), 2023 Q4(a), 2026 Q3(a).

MCQ 32

Strawson refutes the "no-ownership" theory by arguing that it:

A. The theory covertly reintroduces ownership when it speaks of experiences depending on 'my' body. B. The no-ownership theory fails because empirical neuroscience shows that all experience has a bodily cause. C. The no-ownership theory fails because it conflicts with Cartesian substance dualism's separation of mind and body. D. The no-ownership theory fails because private ownership claims cannot be verified through public observation.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "The theory covertly reintroduces ownership when it speaks of experiences depending on 'my' body." Rationale: The theory is self-refuting: "my experiences" cannot be eliminated, so experiences are necessarily owned by a person.

- **B:** False proposition: "The no-ownership theory fails because empirical neuroscience shows that all experience has a bodily cause." Correct replacement: "The theory covertly reintroduces ownership when it speaks of experiences depending on 'my' body." Rationale: Neuroscience and bodily causation are not the logical objection. The no-ownership theory is self-refuting because its appeal to experiences dependent on 'my' body covertly restores a person who owns them.
- **C:** False proposition: "The no-ownership theory fails because it conflicts with Cartesian substance dualism's separation of mind and body." Correct replacement: "The theory covertly reintroduces ownership when it speaks of experiences depending on 'my' body." Rationale: Conflict with Cartesian dualism would not refute the no-ownership theory, and Strawson rejects that dualism anyway. The internal failure is that the theory cannot describe experiences without reintroducing their owner.
- **D:** False proposition: "The no-ownership theory fails because private ownership claims cannot be verified through public observation." Correct replacement: "The theory covertly reintroduces ownership when it speaks of experiences depending on 'my' body." Rationale: This misidentifies the failure as unverifiability of private ownership claims. Strawson's conceptual objection is that relating experiences to 'my' body covertly makes them owned by a person.

Examiner trap: Persons, m/p predicates, self-/other-ascription, other minds and no-ownership must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C08 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b), 2023 Q4(a), 2026 Q3(a).

MCQ 33

In "On Referring" (1950), Strawson's central objection to Russell is that Russell:

A. Russell denies the existence of definite descriptions as meaningful grammatical expressions. B. Russell already accepts truth-value gaps whenever a definite description lacks a referent. C. Russell rejects formal logic and analyses descriptions only through ordinary conversational practice. D. Russell confuses sentence meaning with a speaker's act of referring on an occasion.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Russell denies the existence of definite descriptions as meaningful grammatical expressions." Correct replacement: "Russell confuses sentence meaning with a speaker's act of referring on an occasion." Rationale: Russell does not deny that definite descriptions are meaningful expressions; he gives them a quantified analysis. Strawson objects that this analysis overlooks a speaker's referring use on a particular occasion.
- **B:** False proposition: "Russell already accepts truth-value gaps whenever a definite description lacks a referent." Correct replacement: "Russell confuses sentence meaning with a speaker's act of referring on an occasion." Rationale: This assigns Strawson's truth-value-gap treatment to Russell. Russell's quantified sentence is false when unique existence fails, whereas Strawson distinguishes sentence meaning from an unsuccessful referring use.

- **C:** False proposition: "Russell rejects formal logic and analyses descriptions only through ordinary conversational practice." Correct replacement: "Russell confuses sentence meaning with a speaker's act of referring on an occasion." Rationale: Saying Russell rejects formal logic and relies only on conversation reverses his method. His theory is formal; Strawson argues that it misses a speaker's contextual referring act.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Russell confuses sentence meaning with a speaker's act of referring on an occasion." Rationale: For Strawson people (not sentences) refer, in a use on an occasion; sentence meaning is a set of rules for such use.

Examiner trap: On referring, presupposition, assertion, uniqueness, context and Russell comparison must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C09 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link to Topic 06 Russell; not separately owned through 2026.

MCQ 34

On Strawson's account, "The present King of France is bald" (there being no such king) is:

A. The utterance is straightforwardly true because no existing king can falsify the predicate. B. Neither true nor false, because a presupposition of the referring use fails. C. Does not hold, because the sentence asserts a uniquely existing king and that fails. D. The sentence-type is literally meaningless once its attempted reference lacks an object.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The utterance is straightforwardly true because no existing king can falsify the predicate." Correct replacement: "Neither true nor false, because a presupposition of the referring use fails." Rationale: This mistakes failed reference for vacuous truth. On Strawson's account, the referring use presupposes an existing king; when that presupposition fails, the attempted assertion has a truth-value gap.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Neither true nor false, because a presupposition of the referring use fails." Rationale: A failed presupposition yields a truth-value gap, not a falsehood - the sharp contrast with Russell.
- **C:** False proposition: "Does not hold, because the sentence asserts a uniquely existing king and that fails." Correct replacement: "Neither true nor false, because a presupposition of the referring use fails." Rationale: Saying the sentence asserts a uniquely existing king gives Russell's analysis, not Strawson's. For Strawson, failed presupposition produces a truth-value gap rather than falsity.
- **D:** False proposition: "The sentence-type is literally meaningless once its attempted reference lacks an object." Correct replacement: "Neither true nor false, because a presupposition of the referring use fails." Rationale: The sentence-type remains meaningful because speakers understand its conventional use. What fails is the occasion-specific presupposition of a referent, producing no ordinary true-or-false assertion rather than meaninglessness.

Examiner trap: On referring, presupposition, assertion, uniqueness, context and russell comparison must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C09 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link to Topic 06 Russell; not separately owned through 2026.

MCQ 35

For Russell's Theory of Descriptions ("On Denoting", 1905), the same empty-subject sentence is:

A. The sentence is false because its asserted unique existence condition fails. B. The sentence is neither true nor false because Russell treats existence as a presupposition. C. The sentence is true by default because no unique king exists to instantiate baldness. D. The sentence exhibits presupposition failure rather than the failure of an asserted uniqueness condition.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "The sentence is false because its asserted unique existence condition fails." Rationale: Russell analyses "the" as a quantifier asserting unique existence; with no such king the whole statement is false.
- **B:** False proposition: "The sentence is neither true nor false because Russell treats existence as a presupposition." Correct replacement: "The sentence is false because its asserted unique existence condition fails." Rationale: This misattributes Strawson's presupposition account to Russell. Russell's quantifier analysis asserts existence and uniqueness, so the whole proposition is false when no king satisfies them.
- **C:** False proposition: "The sentence is true by default because no unique king exists to instantiate baldness." Correct replacement: "The sentence is false because its asserted unique existence condition fails." Rationale: The sentence is not true by default merely because no unique king exists. Russell's quantified analysis includes existential and uniqueness conjuncts whose failure makes the whole statement false.
- **D:** False proposition: "The sentence exhibits presupposition failure rather than the failure of an asserted uniqueness condition." Correct replacement: "The sentence is false because its asserted unique existence condition fails." Rationale: This substitutes Strawson's diagnosis for Russell's. Russell treats unique existence as asserted within the quantified proposition, so absence of a referent yields falsity, not a presupposition gap.

Examiner trap: On referring, presupposition, assertion, uniqueness, context and russell comparison must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C09 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link to Topic 06 Russell; not separately owned through 2026.

MCQ 36

Strawson counts as a "critic of empiricism" (the syllabus phrase) chiefly because he argues that:

A. Strawson criticizes empiricism chiefly for making philosophy excessively mathematical and formally regimented. B. Public spatio-temporal identification is prior to any alleged private sense-datum. C. Strawson holds that private sense-data are the only reality and therefore the foundation of identification. D. Strawson argues that induction becomes deductively valid once observations are placed in public space-time.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Strawson criticizes empiricism chiefly for making philosophy excessively mathematical and formally regimented." Correct replacement: "Public spatio-temporal identification is prior to any alleged private sense-datum." Rationale: Making philosophy excessively mathematical and formally regimented is not Strawson's chief objection to empiricism. He argues that public spatio-temporal identification is prior to any private given.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Public spatio-temporal identification is prior to any alleged private sense-datum." Rationale: Strawson attacks empiricism's starting point (the private given), a critique at a different level from Quine's internal reform.
- **C:** False proposition: "Strawson holds that private sense-data are the only reality and therefore the foundation of identification." Correct replacement: "Public spatio-temporal identification is prior to any alleged private sense-datum." Rationale: This states the empiricist starting point Strawson opposes. Publicly re-identifiable bodies are conceptually prior to private sense-data; Quine's separate critique reforms empiricism from within.
- **D:** False proposition: "Strawson argues that induction becomes deductively valid once observations are placed in public space-time." Correct replacement: "Public spatio-temporal identification is prior to any alleged private sense-datum." Rationale: Public location cannot convert induction into deduction, so the conclusion is a non sequitur. Strawson's relevant claim concerns the priority of public identification over any private sensory foundation.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 37

The central disagreement between Quine and Strawson is best framed as whether the conceptual scheme is:

A. The dispute concerns whether the conceptual scheme is simply true or false as one undivided theory. B. The decisive issue is whether the whole conceptual scheme can be expressed in first-order logic. C. Quine treats the scheme as holistically revisable come what may, and Strawson treats a public framework as an indispensable precondition of objective thought. D. The disagreement turns on whether either conceptual scheme permits rational belief in God's existence.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The dispute concerns whether the conceptual scheme is simply true or false as one undivided theory." Correct replacement: "Quine treats the scheme as holistically revisable come what may, and Strawson treats a public framework as an indispensable precondition of objective thought." Rationale: Treating the conceptual scheme as one undivided theory that is simply true or false misses the methodological contrast. Quine stresses revisability; Strawson identifies an indispensable public framework.
- **B:** False proposition: "The decisive issue is whether the whole conceptual scheme can be expressed in first-order logic." Correct replacement: "Quine treats the scheme as holistically revisable come what may, and Strawson treats a public framework as an indispensable precondition of objective thought." Rationale: First-order expressibility is a Quinean tool, not the decisive dispute between the thinkers. The tension is between a revisable web and Strawson's indispensable framework of public identification.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Quine treats the scheme as holistically revisable come what may, and Strawson treats a public framework as an indispensable precondition of objective thought." Rationale: Revisable web versus indispensable framework is the standing tension the examiner most often probes.
- **D:** False proposition: "The disagreement turns on whether either conceptual scheme permits rational belief in God's existence." Correct replacement: "Quine treats the scheme as holistically revisable come what may, and Strawson treats a public framework as an indispensable precondition of objective thought." Rationale: Whether either scheme permits rational belief in God's existence is irrelevant to this disagreement. The issue is holistic revisability versus indispensable conditions of objective thought.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.

MCQ 38

Which of the following is a genuine convergence between Quine and Strawson?

A. Both accept a robust analytic-synthetic distinction as the foundation of empiricist epistemology. B. Both are revisionary metaphysicians who replace ordinary language with ideal logical systems. C. Both deny that experience constrains belief in any way. D. Both reject a private inner object as the anchor of meaning,

making the public / holistic basic.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Both accept a robust analytic-synthetic distinction as the foundation of empiricist epistemology." Correct replacement: "Both reject a private inner object as the anchor of meaning, making the public / holistic basic." Rationale: A robust analytic-synthetic distinction cannot be their shared empiricist foundation because Quine's first-dogma critique rejects it. Their convergence instead concerns public or holistic anchors.
- **B:** False proposition: "Both are revisionary metaphysicians who replace ordinary language with ideal logical systems." Correct replacement: "Both reject a private inner object as the anchor of meaning, making the public / holistic basic." Rationale: This conflates both thinkers with revisionary metaphysicians who replace ordinary language. Strawson describes ordinary structure; their actual convergence makes public or holistic relations basic rather than private givens.
- **C:** False proposition: "Both deny that experience constrains belief in any way." Correct replacement: "Both reject a private inner object as the anchor of meaning, making the public / holistic basic." Rationale: The claim that both deny any experiential constraint is false. Their convergence rejects a private inner object: Quine's web is holistic, and Strawson's criteria are public.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Both reject a private inner object as the anchor of meaning, making the public / holistic basic." Rationale: Quine's behaviourism about meaning and Strawson's public criteria for P-predicates both reject the private given as the anchor of meaning.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.

MCQ 39

Treating Quine and Strawson as "basically agreeing" is a trap because they in fact differ on:

A. They differ on nothing philosophically important once their shared rejection of private givens is recognized. B. Their disagreement concerns terminology alone, since naturalism and descriptive metaphysics name the same method. C. Their central dispute is whether persons exist at all within an acceptable ontology. D. They differ over revisability, meaning and the contrast between naturalist and descriptive methods.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "They differ on nothing philosophically important once their shared rejection of private givens is recognized." Correct replacement: "They differ over revisability, meaning and the contrast between naturalist and descriptive methods." Rationale: This overstates their shared

rejection of private givens as agreement on everything important. Sharp differences remain over revisability, meaning and philosophical method.

- **B:** False proposition: "Their disagreement concerns terminology alone, since naturalism and descriptive metaphysics name the same method." Correct replacement: "They differ over revisability, meaning and the contrast between naturalist and descriptive methods." Rationale: Naturalism and descriptive metaphysics are not verbal variants. Quine places philosophy within revisable science, whereas Strawson maps the conceptual framework already presupposed by thought.
- **C:** False proposition: "Their central dispute is whether persons exist at all within an acceptable ontology." Correct replacement: "They differ over revisability, meaning and the contrast between naturalist and descriptive methods." Rationale: Their central contrast is not an existence dispute about persons. It concerns Quinean revisability and naturalism versus Strawsonian accounts of meaning and indispensable conceptual structure.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "They differ over revisability, meaning and the contrast between naturalist and descriptive methods." Rationale: Their convergence is in target and temper, not doctrine; the substantive differences remain sharp.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.

MCQ 40

The recommended "graded" closing position on the revisable-versus-indispensable question is that:

A. The entire conceptual scheme is uniformly revisable, with no difference in practical resistance among its statements. B. Peripheral claims are readily revisable, and some public framework for re-identifiable subjects remains practically indispensable, and the defensible verdict is layered. C. The entire conceptual scheme is fixed and unrevisable, including peripheral empirical classifications. D. The revisable-versus-indispensable question is meaningless because conceptual schemes cannot be compared or evaluated.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The entire conceptual scheme is uniformly revisable, with no difference in practical resistance among its statements." Correct replacement: "Peripheral claims are readily revisable, and some public framework for re-identifiable subjects remains practically indispensable, and the defensible verdict is layered." Rationale: Calling the whole scheme uniformly revisable with no practical differences mistakes possibility for ease. Quine recognizes entrenchment, while Strawson's public framework remains practically indispensable.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Peripheral claims are readily revisable, and some public framework for re-identifiable subjects remains practically indispensable, and the defensible verdict is layered." Rationale: A layered verdict captures what survives on each side rather than forcing an all-or-nothing choice.

- **C:** False proposition: "The entire conceptual scheme is fixed and unrevisable, including peripheral empirical classifications." Correct replacement: "Peripheral claims are readily revisable, and some public framework for re-identifiable subjects remains practically indispensable, and the defensible verdict is layered." Rationale: This adopts the opposite all-or-nothing extreme. Peripheral empirical classifications are readily revisable even if some framework for identifying enduring subjects remains practically indispensable.
- **D:** False proposition: "The revisable-versus-indispensable question is meaningless because conceptual schemes cannot be compared or evaluated." Correct replacement: "Peripheral claims are readily revisable, and some public framework for re-identifiable subjects remains practically indispensable, and the defensible verdict is layered." Rationale: Calling the question meaningless because schemes cannot be compared evades it. A layered assessment distinguishes revisable peripheral claims from a practically indispensable public framework.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.

MCQ 41

Which attribution observes correct provenance discipline?

A. The bound-variable slogan first appears in "Two Dogmas of Empiricism," published in 1951. B. Quantum logic was proposed jointly by Hilary Putnam and Garrett Birkhoff in 1936. C. Duhem himself extended the underdetermination thesis to all knowledge, including logic. D. The bound-variable slogan comes from Quine's 1948 essay "On What There Is."

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "The bound-variable slogan first appears in "Two Dogmas of Empiricism," published in 1951." Correct replacement: "The bound-variable slogan comes from Quine's 1948 essay "On What There Is."." Rationale: This gives the bound-variable slogan the wrong source and date. Quine presents the ontological-commitment criterion in "On What There Is" (1948), before "Two Dogmas."
- **B:** False proposition: "Quantum logic was proposed jointly by Hilary Putnam and Garrett Birkhoff in 1936." Correct replacement: "The bound-variable slogan comes from Quine's 1948 essay "On What There Is."." Rationale: The attribution and date are conflated: Birkhoff and von Neumann introduced quantum logic in 1936, while Putnam entered later. The correctly sourced option is Quine's 1948 bound-variable slogan.
- **C:** False proposition: "Duhem himself extended the underdetermination thesis to all knowledge, including logic." Correct replacement: "The bound-variable slogan comes from Quine's 1948 essay "On What There Is."." Rationale: This assigns Quine's expansion to Duhem. Duhem restricted the thesis to theoretical physics, while Quine extended holism to science generally and even to logic.

- **D:** Correct proposition: "The bound-variable slogan comes from Quine's 1948 essay "On What There Is."." Rationale: Provenance: the ontological-commitment slogan is 1948; quantum logic is Birkhoff & von Neumann (1936), pressed as empirical revision by Putnam (1968); Duhem restricted his thesis to physics.

Examiner trap: Quine criticisms, provenance and relation to logical positivism or later wittgenstein must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C06 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 42

A common error states Quine's conclusion as "no sentence is really analytic." The accurate statement is that:

A. All sentences become synthetic once no analytic class can be identified by a non-circular criterion. B. Statements commonly called analytic are untenable and should be removed from a rational language. C. Analyticity is identical with necessity by definition, so synonymy needs no further explanation. D. No non-circular criterion marks off analytic truths, even if familiar examples remain.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "All sentences become synthetic once no analytic class can be identified by a non-circular criterion." Correct replacement: "No non-circular criterion marks off analytic truths, even if familiar examples remain." Rationale: Failure to mark a sharp analytic class does not reclassify every sentence as synthetic. Quine challenges the non-circular boundary while allowing that familiar examples still appear analytic.
- **B:** False proposition: "Statements commonly called analytic are untenable and should be removed from a rational language." Correct replacement: "No non-circular criterion marks off analytic truths, even if familiar examples remain." Rationale: Quine does not order familiar analytic-looking sentences removed from rational language. His narrower conclusion is that no principled, non-circular criterion secures their special class.
- **C:** False proposition: "Analyticity is identical with necessity by definition, so synonymy needs no further explanation." Correct replacement: "No non-circular criterion marks off analytic truths, even if familiar examples remain." Rationale: This merely defines analyticity through another intensional notion and bypasses Quine's circularity objection. Necessity and synonymy cannot supply the missing non-circular boundary by stipulation.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "No non-circular criterion marks off analytic truths, even if familiar examples remain." Rationale: Quine denies a principled boundary, not the appearance of analyticity; the over-strong reading loses marks.

Examiner trap: Analyticity, synonymy, definition, interchangeability and semantical rules must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C02 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), 2019 Q1(e), 2024 Q4(c).

MCQ 43

Davidson's "Radical Interpretation" (1973) is often confused with Quine's project. Correctly, it:

A. Radical interpretation differs from translation and treats residual indeterminacy as harmless. B. Radical interpretation is identical to Quine's radical translation in method, evidence and philosophical conclusion. C. Davidson rejects all indeterminacy of meaning and aims to recover a uniquely correct interpretation. D. Davidson denies that linguistic meaning is public and grounds interpretation in private mental objects.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Radical interpretation differs from translation and treats residual indeterminacy as harmless." Rationale: Note the term "interpretation"; Davidson accepts indeterminacy but domesticates it to something like a choice of measurement scale.
- **B:** False proposition: "Radical interpretation is identical to Quine's radical translation in method, evidence and philosophical conclusion." Correct replacement: "Radical interpretation differs from translation and treats residual indeterminacy as harmless." Rationale: This conflates related but distinct projects. Davidson's truth-theoretic radical interpretation and principle of charity differ from Quine's translation manuals, and Davidson treats residual variation more like alternative measurement scales.
- **C:** False proposition: "Davidson rejects all indeterminacy of meaning and aims to recover a uniquely correct interpretation." Correct replacement: "Radical interpretation differs from translation and treats residual indeterminacy as harmless." Rationale: Davidson does not promise one uniquely correct interpretation. He accepts residual indeterminacy but regards appropriately related interpretations as harmless, comparable to choosing different measurement scales.
- **D:** False proposition: "Davidson denies that linguistic meaning is public and grounds interpretation in private mental objects." Correct replacement: "Radical interpretation differs from translation and treats residual indeterminacy as harmless." Rationale: This reverses Davidson's public interpretive method. Radical interpretation uses observable speech and action, not private mental objects, while tolerating limited indeterminacy among equivalent interpretations.

Examiner trap: Quine criticisms, provenance and relation to logical positivism or later wittgenstein must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C06 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C06.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 44

A frequent mistake is to call Strawson's descriptive metaphysics "anti-metaphysical." Correctly, it:

- A. Descriptive metaphysics rejects conceptual analysis and abandons inquiry into the structure of thought.
- B. Is itself metaphysics - it describes the actual structure of our conceptual scheme instead of revising it.
- C. Descriptive metaphysics constructs an ideal logical language to replace the distortions of ordinary speech.
- D. Descriptive metaphysics denies that persons are basic particulars within our conceptual scheme.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Descriptive metaphysics rejects conceptual analysis and abandons inquiry into the structure of thought." Correct replacement: "Is itself metaphysics - it describes the actual structure of our conceptual scheme instead of revising it." Rationale: The option states the opposite of Strawson's method. Descriptive metaphysics uses conceptual analysis to uncover the structure of thought; it is a kind of metaphysics, not its abandonment.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Is itself metaphysics - it describes the actual structure of our conceptual scheme instead of revising it." Rationale: Descriptive versus revisionary is a contrast within metaphysics, not a rejection of it.
- **C:** False proposition: "Descriptive metaphysics constructs an ideal logical language to replace the distortions of ordinary speech." Correct replacement: "Is itself metaphysics - it describes the actual structure of our conceptual scheme instead of revising it." Rationale: This wrongly classifies an ideal logical replacement language as descriptive, although replacement is revisionary. Strawson examines the conceptual scheme already in use.
- **D:** False proposition: "Descriptive metaphysics denies that persons are basic particulars within our conceptual scheme." Correct replacement: "Is itself metaphysics - it describes the actual structure of our conceptual scheme instead of revising it." Rationale: This falsely denies one of Strawson's central descriptive conclusions: persons are basic particulars in our scheme. That conclusion exemplifies metaphysical description rather than rejection of metaphysics.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 45

"In Defence of a Dogma" (1956), which defends the analytic/synthetic distinction against Quine, was written by:

- A. P. F. Strawson alone, as a defence of his own account of ordinary usage.
- B. H. P. Grice and P. F. Strawson, writing as joint defenders of the distinction.
- C. W. V. Quine and Rudolf Carnap, as a shared defence of logical empiricism.
- D. Bertrand Russell and P. F. Strawson, continuing their debate over descriptions.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "P. F. Strawson alone, as a defence of his own account of ordinary usage." Correct replacement: "H. P. Grice and P. F. Strawson, writing as joint defenders of the distinction." Rationale: This omits H. P. Grice and therefore gives false authorship. "In Defence of a Dogma" was jointly written by Grice and Strawson, not by Strawson alone.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "H. P. Grice and P. F. Strawson, writing as joint defenders of the distinction." Rationale: The paper is co-authored by Grice and Strawson; do not attribute it to Strawson alone.
- **C:** False proposition: "W. V. Quine and Rudolf Carnap, as a shared defence of logical empiricism." Correct replacement: "H. P. Grice and P. F. Strawson, writing as joint defenders of the distinction." Rationale: Quine and Carnap were participants on opposing sides of the analyticity dispute, not co-authors of this defence. The paper was written jointly by Grice and Strawson.
- **D:** False proposition: "Bertrand Russell and P. F. Strawson, continuing their debate over descriptions." Correct replacement: "H. P. Grice and P. F. Strawson, writing as joint defenders of the distinction." Rationale: This confuses Strawson's separate debate with Russell over descriptions with the dogma paper. The defence of analyticity was co-authored by Grice and Strawson.

Examiner trap: Analyticity, synonymy, definition, interchangeability and semantical rules must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C02 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C02.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), 2019 Q1(e), 2024 Q4(c).

MCQ 46

Strawson's use of behavioural criteria for P-predicates commits him to the view that:

A. P-predicates simply mean behavioural patterns and therefore support logical behaviourism. B. Behavioural criteria eliminate mental predicates by translating all psychological ascription into physical description. C. Cartesian dualism is correct because behavioural criteria connect an observable body with a separately identifiable mind. D. Behaviour is criterial evidence for P-predicates, not their meaning.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "P-predicates simply mean behavioural patterns and therefore support logical behaviourism." Correct replacement: "Behaviour is criterial evidence for P-predicates, not their meaning." Rationale: This conflates criteria for applying a predicate with its meaning. Behaviour warrants other-ascription of P-predicates, but those predicates are not definitions of behavioural patterns, so Strawson is not a logical behaviourist.
- **B:** False proposition: "Behavioural criteria eliminate mental predicates by translating all psychological ascription into physical description." Correct replacement: "Behaviour is criterial evidence for P-predicates, not their meaning." Rationale: Behavioural criteria do not eliminate

mental predicates or translate psychological ascription into physical description. Behaviour supplies evidence for applying P-predicates rather than defining their meaning.

- **C:** False proposition: "Cartesian dualism is correct because behavioural criteria connect an observable body with a separately identifiable mind." Correct replacement: "Behaviour is criterial evidence for P-predicates, not their meaning." Rationale: The option reintroduces the separately identifiable mind that Strawson's primitive person is designed to avoid. Behaviour is evidence for predicates of one person, not a bridge between two substances.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Behaviour is criterial evidence for P-predicates, not their meaning." Rationale: Strawson insists P-predicates are not reducible to behaviour; behaviour is criterial, not definitional - so he is not a logical behaviourist.

Examiner trap: Persons, m/p predicates, self-/other-ascription, other minds and no-ownership must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C08 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b), 2023 Q4(a), 2026 Q3(a).

MCQ 47

On the empty-subject sentence, the Russell/Strawson split is correctly stated as:

A. Both Russell and Strawson treat the sentence as neither true nor false when the referent is absent. B. Both treat the sentence as false because no present King of France satisfies the description. C. Russell treats the sentence as true, and Strawson treats the attempted assertion as false. D. Russell calls it false, and Strawson says failed reference prevents ordinary assertion.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Both Russell and Strawson treat the sentence as neither true nor false when the referent is absent." Correct replacement: "Russell calls it false, and Strawson says failed reference prevents ordinary assertion." Rationale: This wrongly gives Russell Strawson's verdict. Russell's quantified analysis makes the sentence false, while Strawson treats failed reference as preventing an ordinary true-or-false assertion.
- **B:** False proposition: "Both treat the sentence as false because no present King of France satisfies the description." Correct replacement: "Russell calls it false, and Strawson says failed reference prevents ordinary assertion." Rationale: Saying both philosophers call the sentence false wrongly extends Russell's verdict to Strawson. For Strawson, failed reference defeats ordinary assertion and leaves a truth-value gap.
- **C:** False proposition: "Russell treats the sentence as true, and Strawson treats the attempted assertion as false." Correct replacement: "Russell calls it false, and Strawson says failed reference prevents ordinary assertion." Rationale: Both verdicts are reversed. Russell calls the quantified proposition false because existence fails; Strawson says the failed reference prevents an ordinary assertion rather than making it false.

- **D:** Correct proposition: "Russell calls it false, and Strawson says failed reference prevents ordinary assertion." Rationale: The verdicts diverge precisely on Russellian falsity versus Strawson's failed-assertion treatment.

Examiner trap: On referring, presupposition, assertion, uniqueness, context and russell comparison must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C09 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link to Topic 06 Russell; not separately owned through 2026.

MCQ 48

How should Quine's early claim that even logical laws are revisable be qualified by his later philosophy of logic?

A. Quine consistently treats all logical laws as experimentally disposable whenever one anomalous observation appears. B. The later qualification restores an unrevisable analytic class and withdraws confirmation holism altogether. C. Later Quine qualifies revisability through minimum mutilation and the risk of changing the subject. D. Quine transfers the authority to revise logic from scientific practice to Strawson's descriptive metaphysics.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Quine consistently treats all logical laws as experimentally disposable whenever one anomalous observation appears." Correct replacement: "Later Quine qualifies revisability through minimum mutilation and the risk of changing the subject." Rationale: Calling every logical law disposable after one anomaly grossly overstates revisability. Later Quine protects logic through minimum mutilation and warns that radical alteration may change the subject.
- **B:** False proposition: "The later qualification restores an unrevisable analytic class and withdraws confirmation holism altogether." Correct replacement: "Later Quine qualifies revisability through minimum mutilation and the risk of changing the subject." Rationale: The later qualification does not revive analyticity or abandon holism. It adds pragmatic resistance through minimum mutilation and notes that sufficiently radical logical revision may amount to changing the subject.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Later Quine qualifies revisability through minimum mutilation and the risk of changing the subject." Rationale: Early universal revisability is constrained by conservatism, minimum mutilation and the later warning that sufficiently radical logical change can amount to a change of subject.
- **D:** False proposition: "Quine transfers the authority to revise logic from scientific practice to Strawson's descriptive metaphysics." Correct replacement: "Later Quine qualifies revisability through minimum mutilation and the risk of changing the subject." Rationale: Strawson's descriptive metaphysics has no authority in Quine's account of logical revision. The qualification remains internal to scientific practice: conserve the web and avoid revisions that change the subject.

Examiner trap: Reductionism, holism, duhem-quine, revisability and logical-law qualification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C03 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C03.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q3(c), 2024 Q4(c), 2025 Q4(b).

MCQ 49

What is the safest statement of the Quine-Putnam indispensability line within Quine's account of ontological commitment?

A. Indispensability proves that all nouns in successful science name an independently existing abstract object. B. Quine's taste for desert landscapes requires nominalism even when mathematics is indispensable to physical theory. C. The argument bypasses regimentation because ontological commitment can be read directly from ordinary grammar. D. Scientific indispensability can support commitment to abstract entities quantified over by our best theory, and the broader argument extends beyond Quine's bound-variable slogan.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Indispensability proves that all nouns in successful science name an independently existing abstract object." Correct replacement: "Scientific indispensability can support commitment to abstract entities quantified over by our best theory, and the broader argument extends beyond Quine's bound-variable slogan." Rationale: This mistakes surface nouns for ontological commitment and overstates the conclusion. Commitment follows indispensable quantification in regimented best science, not every noun occurring in successful discourse.
- **B:** False proposition: "Quine's taste for desert landscapes requires nominalism even when mathematics is indispensable to physical theory." Correct replacement: "Scientific indispensability can support commitment to abstract entities quantified over by our best theory, and the broader argument extends beyond Quine's bound-variable slogan." Rationale: Quine's preference for sparse ontology is not nominalism at any cost. If best regimented science indispensably quantifies over abstract entities, his criterion can support commitment to them.
- **C:** False proposition: "The argument bypasses regimentation because ontological commitment can be read directly from ordinary grammar." Correct replacement: "Scientific indispensability can support commitment to abstract entities quantified over by our best theory, and the broader argument extends beyond Quine's bound-variable slogan." Rationale: This ignores a necessary Quinean step. Ordinary grammar can mislead about commitment, so the accepted theory must first be regimented before its bound variables reveal what it quantifies over.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "Scientific indispensability can support commitment to abstract entities quantified over by our best theory, and the broader argument extends beyond Quine's bound-variable slogan." Rationale: Quinean commitment follows the quantifiers of regimented best science; mathematical indispensability may therefore support abstract commitment, but slogan and argument must not be conflated.

Examiner trap: Ontological commitment, canonical notation, indispensability and naturalized epistemology must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C04 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), with bounded system-enrichment only.

MCQ 50

What do proxy functions show in Quine's discussion of reference and ontology?

A. All terms have one absolute referent fixed before any background theory or translation manual is adopted. B. Proxy functions prove that rival scientific theories can not be empirically equivalent at the sentence level. C. Systematic reinterpretations can permute objects and preserving sentence-level truth, reinforcing the relativity or inscrutability of reference. D. They provide Strawson's criterion for identifying persons through psychological predicates alone.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "All terms have one absolute referent fixed before any background theory or translation manual is adopted." Correct replacement: "Systematic reinterpretations can permute objects and preserving sentence-level truth, reinforcing the relativity or inscrutability of reference." Rationale: This reverses the lesson of proxy functions by giving every term an absolute referent before any background theory. Objects can instead be remapped while sentence-level truth is preserved.
- **B:** False proposition: "Proxy functions prove that rival scientific theories can not be empirically equivalent at the sentence level." Correct replacement: "Systematic reinterpretations can permute objects and preserving sentence-level truth, reinforcing the relativity or inscrutability of reference." Rationale: The option reverses what proxy functions establish. They display systematic reinterpretations that preserve sentence-level truth and thus can sustain empirical equivalence while changing object assignments.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Systematic reinterpretations can permute objects and preserving sentence-level truth, reinforcing the relativity or inscrutability of reference." Rationale: A proxy function can systematically remap objects while truth conditions are preserved, illustrating that reference is not fixed from a theory-independent standpoint.
- **D:** False proposition: "They provide Strawson's criterion for identifying persons through psychological predicates alone." Correct replacement: "Systematic reinterpretations can permute objects and preserving sentence-level truth, reinforcing the relativity or inscrutability of reference." Rationale: This misattributes proxy functions to Strawson's psychological identification of persons. Quine uses them to remap objects while preserving sentence-level truth, illustrating relative reference.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 51

Which distinction prevents Quinean underdetermination from being identified automatically with indeterminacy of translation?

A. Underdetermination concerns rival theories compatible with evidence, and translation indeterminacy adds the naturalistic claim that no further semantic fact selects among manuals. B. Underdetermination applies only to logic, and translation indeterminacy applies only to sensory observation sentences. C. Translation indeterminacy is weaker because it assumes one uniquely correct manual that the available evidence has failed to discover. D. The two doctrines are identical by definition and Quine offers no proposed asymmetry between physics and semantics.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Underdetermination concerns rival theories compatible with evidence, and translation indeterminacy adds the naturalistic claim that no further semantic fact selects among manuals." Rationale: The special semantic thesis denies a further fact of meaning beyond the total behavioural evidence, whereas ordinary scientific underdetermination need not deny a fact of the matter.
- **B:** False proposition: "Underdetermination applies only to logic, and translation indeterminacy applies only to sensory observation sentences." Correct replacement: "Underdetermination concerns rival theories compatible with evidence, and translation indeterminacy adds the naturalistic claim that no further semantic fact selects among manuals." Rationale: Both scope claims are false. Scientific underdetermination ranges beyond logic, while translation indeterminacy concerns rival manuals generally and adds that no further semantic fact selects one.
- **C:** False proposition: "Translation indeterminacy is weaker because it assumes one uniquely correct manual that the available evidence has failed to discover." Correct replacement: "Underdetermination concerns rival theories compatible with evidence, and translation indeterminacy adds the naturalistic claim that no further semantic fact selects among manuals." Rationale: This reverses the distinctive force of indeterminacy. Quine denies a hidden uniquely correct manual beyond behavioural evidence, whereas ordinary scientific underdetermination may leave a fact of the matter undiscovered.
- **D:** False proposition: "The two doctrines are identical by definition and Quine offers no proposed asymmetry between physics and semantics." Correct replacement: "Underdetermination concerns rival theories compatible with evidence, and translation indeterminacy adds the naturalistic claim that no further semantic fact selects among manuals." Rationale: The doctrines are not identical by definition. Quine distinguishes semantic indeterminacy by denying any further fact of meaning, a stronger claim than ordinary evidential underdetermination in physics.

Examiner trap: Radical translation, stimulus meaning, gavagai, inscrutability, proxy functions and underdetermination must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C05 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C05.

PYQ linkage: No independently owned PYQ through 2026; enrichment must remain bounded.

MCQ 52

How does Strawson connect the subject-predicate framework with his theory of basic particulars?

A. Subject-predicate form is discarded because only feature-placing sentences can express objective claims. B. Predicates identify themselves without any framework of demonstrative reference or re-identification. C. Ordinary predication depends on publicly identifying a basic particular as its subject. D. The framework proves that all grammatical subjects denote an immaterial Cartesian substance.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Subject-predicate form is discarded because only feature-placing sentences can express objective claims." Correct replacement: "Ordinary predication depends on publicly identifying a basic particular as its subject." Rationale: This overstates the limited role of feature-placing expressions. Strawson retains ordinary subject-predicate form, which depends on identifying basic particulars as public objects of reference.
- **B:** False proposition: "Predicates identify themselves without any framework of demonstrative reference or re-identification." Correct replacement: "Ordinary predication depends on publicly identifying a basic particular as its subject." Rationale: Predicates do not identify themselves or supply their own subjects. Ordinary predication requires demonstrative reference and re-identification of a basic particular within the public framework.
- **C:** Correct proposition: "Ordinary predication depends on publicly identifying a basic particular as its subject." Rationale: Strawson treats basic particulars as basic objects of reference: identifying a subject makes ordinary predication possible, although feature-placing expressions remain a bounded complication.
- **D:** False proposition: "The framework proves that all grammatical subjects denote an immaterial Cartesian substance." Correct replacement: "Ordinary predication depends on publicly identifying a basic particular as its subject." Rationale: This infers metaphysical substance from grammatical form and contradicts Strawson's anti-dualism. Basic subjects of reference are publicly identifiable bodies and persons, not necessarily immaterial Cartesian egos.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 53

What is the relation between identification and re-identification in Strawson's argument for material bodies?

A. Objective identification requires the possibility of tracing the same particular through one spatio-temporal framework, so re-identification is a condition of robust identification. B. Identification is momentary acquaintance, and re-identification is an optional memory exercise with no bearing on objectivity. C. Re-identification applies only to private sensations because public bodies are immediately self-identifying. D. The two notions are interchangeable names for Russell's quantified analysis of definite descriptions.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Objective identification requires the possibility of tracing the same particular through one spatio-temporal framework, so re-identification is a condition of robust identification." Rationale: To identify an objective particular is to place it in a system in which it can count as the same item again; material bodies supply the enduring public anchors.
- **B:** False proposition: "Identification is momentary acquaintance, and re-identification is an optional memory exercise with no bearing on objectivity." Correct replacement: "Objective identification requires the possibility of tracing the same particular through one spatio-temporal framework, so re-identification is a condition of robust identification." Rationale: This reduces identification to a private moment and makes objectivity accidental. For Strawson, identifying a particular requires criteria for recognizing the same item again within an enduring public framework.
- **C:** False proposition: "Re-identification applies only to private sensations because public bodies are immediately self-identifying." Correct replacement: "Objective identification requires the possibility of tracing the same particular through one spatio-temporal framework, so re-identification is a condition of robust identification." Rationale: The option reverses Strawson's application. Public material bodies require and enable re-identification across times and viewpoints; private sensations do not provide the enduring shared anchors.
- **D:** False proposition: "The two notions are interchangeable names for Russell's quantified analysis of definite descriptions." Correct replacement: "Objective identification requires the possibility of tracing the same particular through one spatio-temporal framework, so re-identification is a condition of robust identification." Rationale: This conflates Strawson's metaphysics of object identity with Russell's semantic analysis of descriptions. Re-identification means tracing the same particular through public space-time, not quantifier paraphrase.

Examiner trap: Descriptive metaphysics, basic particulars, identification and re-identification must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C07 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C07.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q3(b), 2021 Q3(b).

MCQ 54

How does Strawson's primitive concept of a person address the problem of other minds?

A. Other minds are known by deductively proving that each visible body contains an unobservable ego. B. Psychological predicates are other-ascribed through public criteria and self-ascribed non-observationally, avoiding an inference to hidden Cartesian minds. C. The problem disappears because P-predicates are reducible without remainder to movements of material bodies. D. Self-ascription is prior and intelligible even if predicates of consciousness can not apply to anyone else.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Other minds are known by deductively proving that each visible body contains an unobservable ego." Correct replacement: "Psychological predicates are other-ascribed through public criteria and self-ascribed non-observationally, avoiding an inference to hidden Cartesian minds." Rationale: Strawson rejects deductively proving that each visible body contains an unobservable ego. P-predicates instead have first- and third-person uses grounded by public criteria.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Psychological predicates are other-ascribed through public criteria and self-ascribed non-observationally, avoiding an inference to hidden Cartesian minds." Rationale: The same P-predicate has first-person and third-person uses; public criteria make other-ascription possible without reducing experience to behaviour or postulating hidden egos.
- **C:** False proposition: "The problem disappears because P-predicates are reducible without remainder to movements of material bodies." Correct replacement: "Psychological predicates are other-ascribed through public criteria and self-ascribed non-observationally, avoiding an inference to hidden Cartesian minds." Rationale: This collapses Strawson's criterial account into logical behaviourism. Bodily behaviour supports other-ascription, but P-predicates are not reducible without remainder to physical movements.
- **D:** False proposition: "Self-ascription is prior and intelligible even if predicates of consciousness can not apply to anyone else." Correct replacement: "Psychological predicates are other-ascribed through public criteria and self-ascribed non-observationally, avoiding an inference to hidden Cartesian minds." Rationale: This isolates first-person use in exactly the way Strawson denies. Self-ascription is intelligible only within a practice in which the same consciousness predicates apply to other persons through public criteria.

Examiner trap: Persons, m/p predicates, self-/other-ascription, other minds and no-ownership must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C08 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C08.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q1(e), 2021 Q3(b), 2023 Q4(a), 2026 Q3(a).

MCQ 55

What role do uniqueness and context play in Strawson's critique of Russell's theory of descriptions?

A. A description can identify a contextually salient individual rather than assert Russell's full existence-and-uniqueness analysis as the conversational point. B. Context eliminates all uniqueness condition because definite descriptions invariably function as proper names. C. Strawson denies that speakers ever use descriptions referentially on particular occasions. D. Uniqueness alone guarantees successful reference even when the existence presupposition plainly fails.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "A description can identify a contextually salient individual rather than assert Russell's full existence-and-uniqueness analysis as the conversational point." Rationale: Strawson shifts attention from sentence form to an occasion of use: contextual identification and background presupposition are not identical with the full asserted content of Russell's analysis.
- **B:** False proposition: "Context eliminates all uniqueness condition because definite descriptions invariably function as proper names." Correct replacement: "A description can identify a contextually salient individual rather than assert Russell's full existence-and-uniqueness analysis as the conversational point." Rationale: Context can determine which individual is salient without abolishing uniqueness or turning every description into a name. Strawson's point is about the conversational referring use, not elimination of descriptive conditions.
- **C:** False proposition: "Strawson denies that speakers ever use descriptions referentially on particular occasions." Correct replacement: "A description can identify a contextually salient individual rather than assert Russell's full existence-and-uniqueness analysis as the conversational point." Rationale: This states the opposite of Strawson's central move. He emphasizes that speakers use descriptions referentially on particular occasions, and that this act is not exhausted by Russell's asserted content.
- **D:** False proposition: "Uniqueness alone guarantees successful reference even when the existence presupposition plainly fails." Correct replacement: "A description can identify a contextually salient individual rather than assert Russell's full existence-and-uniqueness analysis as the conversational point." Rationale: Uniqueness cannot secure reference when nothing satisfies the description. Successful contextual identification still presupposes an existent salient individual; otherwise the referring use fails.

Examiner trap: On referring, presupposition, assertion, uniqueness, context and Russell comparison must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C09 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link to Topic 06 Russell; not separately owned through 2026.

MCQ 56

Which formulation accurately distinguishes presupposition failure, falsehood and meaning in Strawson's original 'On Referring' account?

A. The sentence-type remains meaningful, and an unsuccessful referring use ordinarily fails to make a true-or-false assertion when its existence presupposition is unmet. B. The sentence becomes meaningless because all unsupported presuppositions destroy the grammar of the expression. C. The use is straightforwardly incorrect for exactly Russell's reason that unique existence is asserted. D. The use becomes true by default because no existing object can falsify the predicate applied.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "The sentence-type remains meaningful, and an unsuccessful referring use ordinarily fails to make a true-or-false assertion when its existence presupposition is unmet." Rationale: Strawson's truth-value-gap claim concerns the unsuccessful use or assertion, not the meaningfulness of the sentence-type; later presupposition theories need not copy this result.
- **B:** False proposition: "The sentence becomes meaningless because all unsupported presuppositions destroy the grammar of the expression." Correct replacement: "The sentence-type remains meaningful, and an unsuccessful referring use ordinarily fails to make a true-or-false assertion when its existence presupposition is unmet." Rationale: An unsupported presupposition does not destroy grammar or sentence-type meaning. It instead prevents that particular referring use from making an ordinary true-or-false assertion.
- **C:** False proposition: "The use is straightforwardly incorrect for exactly Russell's reason that unique existence is asserted." Correct replacement: "The sentence-type remains meaningful, and an unsuccessful referring use ordinarily fails to make a true-or-false assertion when its existence presupposition is unmet." Rationale: This imports Russell's asserted unique-existence analysis into Strawson's account. For Strawson the sentence-type remains meaningful, but failed presupposition prevents an ordinary true-or-false assertion.
- **D:** False proposition: "The use becomes true by default because no existing object can falsify the predicate applied." Correct replacement: "The sentence-type remains meaningful, and an unsuccessful referring use ordinarily fails to make a true-or-false assertion when its existence presupposition is unmet." Rationale: Failed reference does not make the predicate vacuously true. The sentence-type is meaningful, but its unsuccessful referring use normally fails to produce any true-or-false assertion.

Examiner trap: On referring, presupposition, assertion, uniqueness, context and Russell comparison must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C09 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C09.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link to Topic 06 Russell; not separately owned through 2026.

MCQ 57

What is the central normative objection to Quine's naturalized epistemology?

A. Naturalized epistemology is too normative because it refuses all empirical description of human cognition. B. A causal account may describe how sensory input produces belief and still fail to explain which beliefs or methods ought to be accepted. C. The programme fails only because psychology cannot investigate perception or language acquisition scientifically. D. Quine retains an external Cartesian foundation and therefore duplicates traditional first philosophy.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Naturalized epistemology is too normative because it refuses all empirical description of human cognition." Correct replacement: "A causal account may describe how sensory input produces belief and still fail to explain which beliefs or methods ought to be accepted." Rationale: This reverses the standard objection. Quine's programme welcomes empirical description of cognition; critics worry that causal psychology is not normative enough to explain what one ought to believe.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "A causal account may describe how sensory input produces belief and still fail to explain which beliefs or methods ought to be accepted." Rationale: Replacing justification with causal psychology appears to lose the normative question; Quinean engineering may improve methods within science but does not simply derive ought from cause.
- **C:** False proposition: "The programme fails only because psychology cannot investigate perception or language acquisition scientifically." Correct replacement: "A causal account may describe how sensory input produces belief and still fail to explain which beliefs or methods ought to be accepted." Rationale: Psychology's ability to investigate perception is assumed, not denied. The objection is that even a successful causal account may leave unanswered which beliefs and methods are epistemically justified.
- **D:** False proposition: "Quine retains an external Cartesian foundation and therefore duplicates traditional first philosophy." Correct replacement: "A causal account may describe how sensory input produces belief and still fail to explain which beliefs or methods ought to be accepted." Rationale: This attributes an external Cartesian foundation and traditional first philosophy to Quine, who rejects both. The real objection is that causal psychology may not answer which beliefs ought to be accepted.

Examiner trap: Ontological commitment, canonical notation, indispensability and naturalized epistemology must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C04 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C04.

PYQ linkage: 2018 Q2(c), with bounded system-enrichment only.

MCQ 58

What is the strongest limitation of Strawson's descriptive metaphysics as a metaphysical method?

A. Descriptive metaphysics can map indispensable features of our scheme, and this does not prove unique correctness, unrevisability or correspondence with mind-independent reality. B. It is self-defeating because description necessarily eliminates all concepts used in ordinary thought. C. It supplies a complete causal explanation of how material bodies generate states of consciousness. D. It becomes revisionary whenever it identifies a condition of possible reference or objective thought.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Descriptive metaphysics can map indispensable features of our scheme, and this does not prove unique correctness, unrevisability or correspondence with mind-independent reality." Rationale: Descriptive metaphysics deliberately works from within our conceptual scheme; that internal strength leaves an external uniqueness and reality question unresolved.
- **B:** False proposition: "It is self-defeating because description necessarily eliminates all concepts used in ordinary thought." Correct replacement: "Descriptive metaphysics can map indispensable features of our scheme, and this does not prove unique correctness, unrevisability or correspondence with mind-independent reality." Rationale: Calling description self-defeating because it eliminates every ordinary concept invents a contradiction. The actual limitation is that mapping our scheme does not establish unique correctness or mind-independent reality.
- **C:** False proposition: "It supplies a complete causal explanation of how material bodies generate states of consciousness." Correct replacement: "Descriptive metaphysics can map indispensable features of our scheme, and this does not prove unique correctness, unrevisability or correspondence with mind-independent reality." Rationale: A complete causal explanation of how bodies generate consciousness is not descriptive metaphysics' task. It maps conceptual dependencies and leaves external uniqueness and reality unsettled.
- **D:** False proposition: "It becomes revisionary whenever it identifies a condition of possible reference or objective thought." Correct replacement: "Descriptive metaphysics can map indispensable features of our scheme, and this does not prove unique correctness, unrevisability or correspondence with mind-independent reality." Rationale: Identifying a condition of reference can remain descriptive when it articulates commitments already implicit in our scheme. Revisionary metaphysics proposes a replacement scheme; that is not automatic here.

Examiner trap: Strawson limitations and bounded reactive-attitudes enrichment must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C10 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: No independent routed demand; use only after the printed Strawson core.

MCQ 59

How should Strawson's 'Freedom and Resentment' and reactive attitudes be handled in this printed syllabus item?

A. Reactive attitudes replace the concept of a person and therefore form the sole core of Strawson's syllabus ownership. B. They belong to Quine's naturalized epistemology because resentment is a behavioural disposition. C. They establish the analytic-synthetic distinction defended jointly by Quine and Strawson. D. They are source-recognized bounded enrichment, not a substitute for the printed theories of basic particulars and persons or an independently routed PYQ demand.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Reactive attitudes replace the concept of a person and therefore form the sole core of Strawson's syllabus ownership." Correct replacement: "They are source-recognized bounded enrichment, not a substitute for the printed theories of basic particulars and persons or an independently routed PYQ demand." Rationale: This displaces the printed syllabus with a later enrichment topic. Reactive attitudes illuminate personhood but do not replace Strawson's core accounts of basic particulars and persons in Individuals.
- **B:** False proposition: "They belong to Quine's naturalized epistemology because resentment is a behavioural disposition." Correct replacement: "They are source-recognized bounded enrichment, not a substitute for the printed theories of basic particulars and persons or an independently routed PYQ demand." Rationale: This is a clear misattribution. Reactive attitudes belong to Strawson's free-will work, not Quine's naturalized epistemology, and should appear only after the Individuals material is covered.
- **C:** False proposition: "They establish the analytic-synthetic distinction defended jointly by Quine and Strawson." Correct replacement: "They are source-recognized bounded enrichment, not a substitute for the printed theories of basic particulars and persons or an independently routed PYQ demand." Rationale: Reactive attitudes concern moral responsibility, not an analytic-synthetic distinction jointly defended by Quine and Strawson. They are bounded enrichment after the core theories of particulars and persons.
- **D:** Correct proposition: "They are source-recognized bounded enrichment, not a substitute for the printed theories of basic particulars and persons or an independently routed PYQ demand." Rationale: The sources acknowledge the free-will work but keep it outside the primary printed burden; it may enrich a person answer only after Individuals has been completed.

Examiner trap: Strawson limitations and bounded reactive-attitudes enrichment must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C10 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C10.

PYQ linkage: No independent routed demand; use only after the printed Strawson core.

MCQ 60

Which comparison keeps Quinean naturalism and holism distinct from Strawsonian descriptive metaphysics?

A. Both philosophers reduce philosophy to experimental psychology and reject all framework conditions of reference. B. Quine places inquiry inside revisable science, and Strawson maps our conceptual framework rather than treating that map as natural science. C. Strawson's web of belief naturalizes epistemology, and Quine's basic particulars describe ordinary language. D. Their methods are interchangeable because both defend the same analytic-synthetic distinction against logical positivism.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** False proposition: "Both philosophers reduce philosophy to experimental psychology and reject all framework conditions of reference." Correct replacement: "Quine places inquiry inside revisable science, and Strawson maps our conceptual framework rather than treating that map as natural science." Rationale: This projects Quine's psychological naturalization onto Strawson and erases Strawson's framework conditions. Quine works within revisable science; Strawson describes the conceptual structure required for reference.
- **B:** Correct proposition: "Quine places inquiry inside revisable science, and Strawson maps our conceptual framework rather than treating that map as natural science." Rationale: Quine's science-continuous revision and Strawson's connective description answer different methodological questions; shared anti-foundational pressures do not merge the projects.
- **C:** False proposition: "Strawson's web of belief naturalizes epistemology, and Quine's basic particulars describe ordinary language." Correct replacement: "Quine places inquiry inside revisable science, and Strawson maps our conceptual framework rather than treating that map as natural science." Rationale: The web of belief and naturalized epistemology are wrongly assigned to Strawson, while basic particulars are wrongly assigned to Quine. Quine revises within science; Strawson maps the conceptual framework.
- **D:** False proposition: "Their methods are interchangeable because both defend the same analytic-synthetic distinction against logical positivism." Correct replacement: "Quine places inquiry inside revisable science, and Strawson maps our conceptual framework rather than treating that map as natural science." Rationale: Their methods are not interchangeable, and Quine does not defend the analytic-synthetic distinction. His science-continuous revision contrasts with Strawson's descriptive mapping of our conceptual framework.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.

MCQ 61

What is the most defensible overall relation between Topic 11 and Logical Positivism or Russell and early Wittgenstein?

A. Topic 11 owns Quine's critique and Strawson's rival analyses, and the positive systems of verificationism, descriptions and logical atomism remain cross-links owned by Topics 07 and 06. B. Quine and Strawson jointly own the entire Vienna Circle programme and Russell's logical atomism. C. All criticism of verification or descriptions transfers the original doctrine into Topic 11 ownership. D. Cross-links must be removed because neighbouring analytic philosophers cannot illuminate one another.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct proposition: "Topic 11 owns Quine's critique and Strawson's rival analyses, and the positive systems of verificationism, descriptions and logical atomism remain cross-links owned by Topics 07 and 06." Rationale: Ownership follows the principal argumentative burden: Topic 11 uses bounded contrasts without duplicating the primary systems already solved under Logical Positivism and Russell or early Wittgenstein.
- **B:** False proposition: "Quine and Strawson jointly own the entire Vienna Circle programme and Russell's logical atomism." Correct replacement: "Topic 11 owns Quine's critique and Strawson's rival analyses, and the positive systems of verificationism, descriptions and logical atomism remain cross-links owned by Topics 07 and 06." Rationale: This grossly overassigns ownership. Topic 11 covers Quine's critique and Strawson's alternatives; the Vienna Circle's positive verificationism and Russell's logical atomism belong to their own topics.
- **C:** False proposition: "All criticism of verification or descriptions transfers the original doctrine into Topic 11 ownership." Correct replacement: "Topic 11 owns Quine's critique and Strawson's rival analyses, and the positive systems of verificationism, descriptions and logical atomism remain cross-links owned by Topics 07 and 06." Rationale: Criticizing a doctrine does not transfer ownership of its positive system. Topic 11 uses verificationism and Russellian descriptions as bounded contrasts while Topics 07 and 06 retain the principal exposition.
- **D:** False proposition: "Cross-links must be removed because neighbouring analytic philosophers cannot illuminate one another." Correct replacement: "Topic 11 owns Quine's critique and Strawson's rival analyses, and the positive systems of verificationism, descriptions and logical atomism remain cross-links owned by Topics 07 and 06." Rationale: The claim that cross-links must be removed because neighbouring philosophers cannot illuminate one another is false. Bounded comparisons are useful while primary doctrines remain with their own topics.

Examiner trap: Quine-strawson comparison and ownership reconciliation with topics 06-10 must be stated without ownership transfer or scope inflation.

Repair action: Reconstruct C11 in the Revision Guide and explain the keyed relation without options.

Coverage mapping: C11.

PYQ linkage: Ownership reconciliation across Topics 06–10 and all Topic 11 PYQs.